

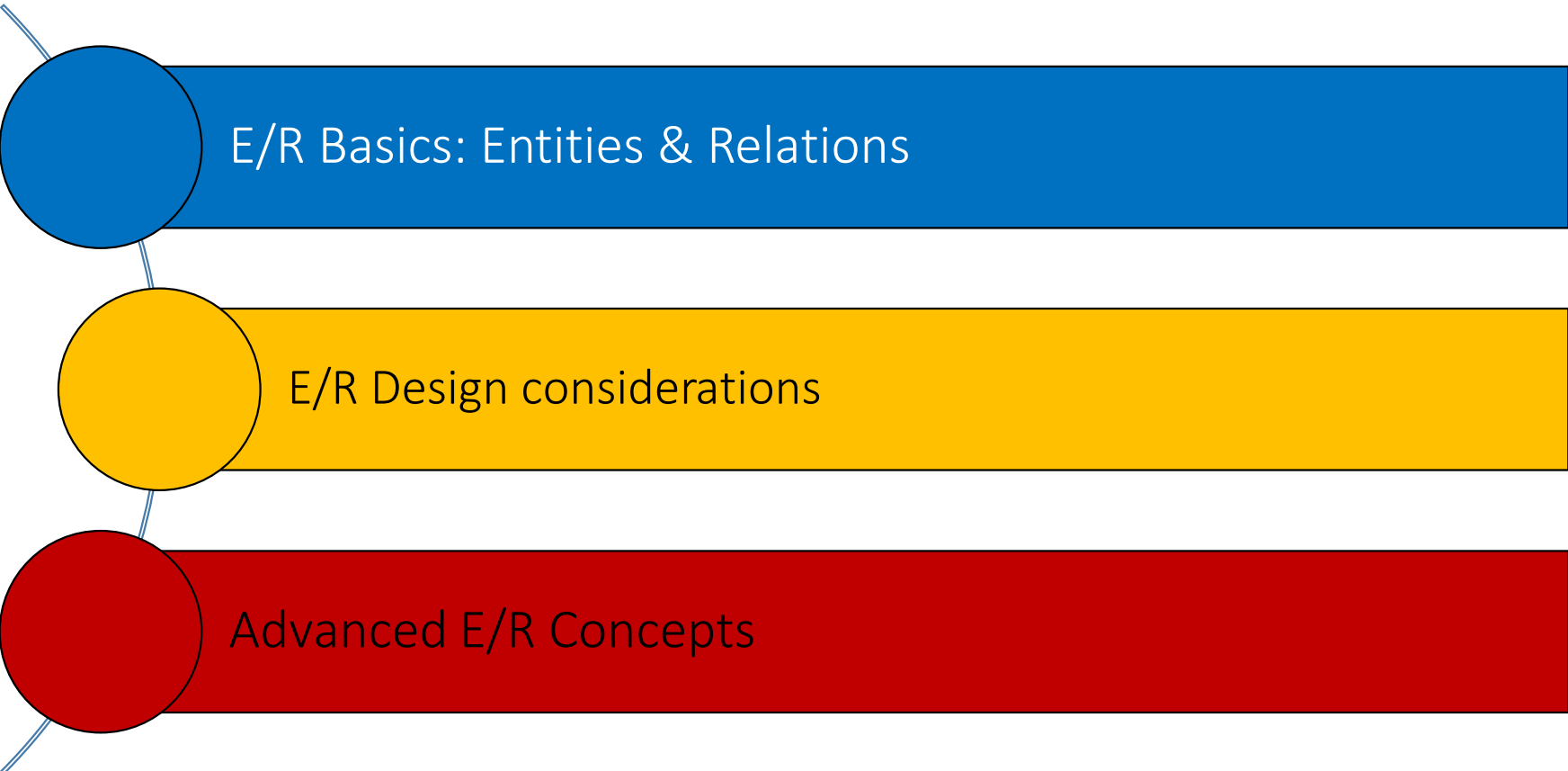
# CSE 303: Database

## Lecture 12

2022

## Chapter 4: E-R diagram

# Outline



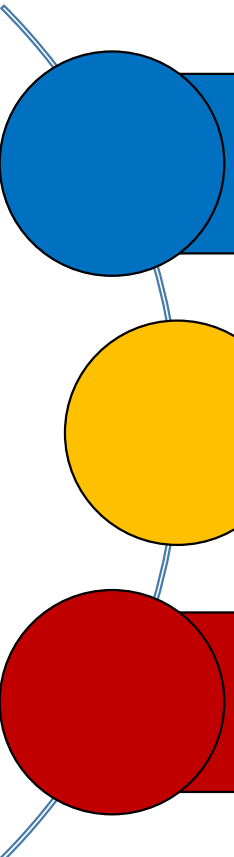
E/R Basics: Entities & Relations

E/R Design considerations

Advanced E/R Concepts

# 1. E/R Basics: Entities & Relations

# What you will learn about in this section



High-level motivation for the E/R model

Entities

Relationships

# Database Design

- **Database design: Why do we need it?**
  - Agree on structure of the database before deciding on a particular implementation
- **Consider issues such as:**
  - What entities to model
  - How entities are related
  - What constraints exist in the domain
  - How to achieve good designs
- **Several formalisms exist**
  - We discuss one flavor of E/R diagrams

# Database Design Process

1. Requirements Analysis

2. Conceptual Design

3. Logical, Physical, Security, etc.

## 1. Requirements analysis

- What is going to be stored?
- How is it going to be used?
- What are we going to do with the data?
- Who should access the data?

Technical and non-technical people are involved

Taught in course on system analysis and design

# Database Design Process

1. Requirements Analysis

2. Conceptual Design

3. Logical, Physical, Security, etc.

## 2. Conceptual Design

- A high-level description of the database
- Sufficiently precise that technical people can understand it
- But, not so precise that non-technical people can't participate

This is where E/R diagram fits in.

# Database Design Process

1. Requirements Analysis

2. Conceptual Design

3. Logical, Physical, Security, etc.

## 3. More:

- Logical Database Design
  - Translation of ER diagram to a relational database schema (description of tables)
- Physical Database Design
- Security Design



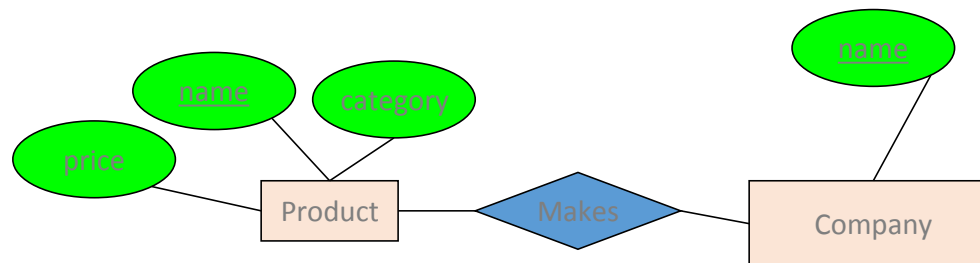
# Database Design Process

1. Requirements Analysis

2. Conceptual Design

3. Logical, Physical, Security, etc.

E/R Model & Diagrams used



This process is iterated many times

E/R diagram is a *visual syntax* for DB design which is ***precise enough*** for technical points, but ***abstracted enough*** for non-technical people

# Requirement Engineering

- **Tasks** and **techniques** that lead to an **understanding** of **requirements** is called **requirement engineering**.
- Requirement engineering **provides** appropriate **mechanism** for **understanding**
  - What **customer wants**
  - Analyzing **needs**
  - Assessing **feasibility**
  - **Negotiating** a reasonable solution
  - **Specifying** solution **unambiguously**
  - **Validating** the **specification**
  - **Managing** requirements



# Requirements Engineering is Hard

“The **hardest** single **part** of building a software system is **deciding what to build**. No part of the work so cripples the resulting system if done wrong.”



**"Fred" Brooks Jr.** is an American computer architect, software engineer, and computer scientist, best known for managing the development of IBM's System/360 family of computers

“The **seeds** of major software **disasters** are usually **shown** in the **first three months** of commencing the software project.”

**Capers Jones** is an American specialist in software engineering methodologies



Failures

Requirements Definition/Importance

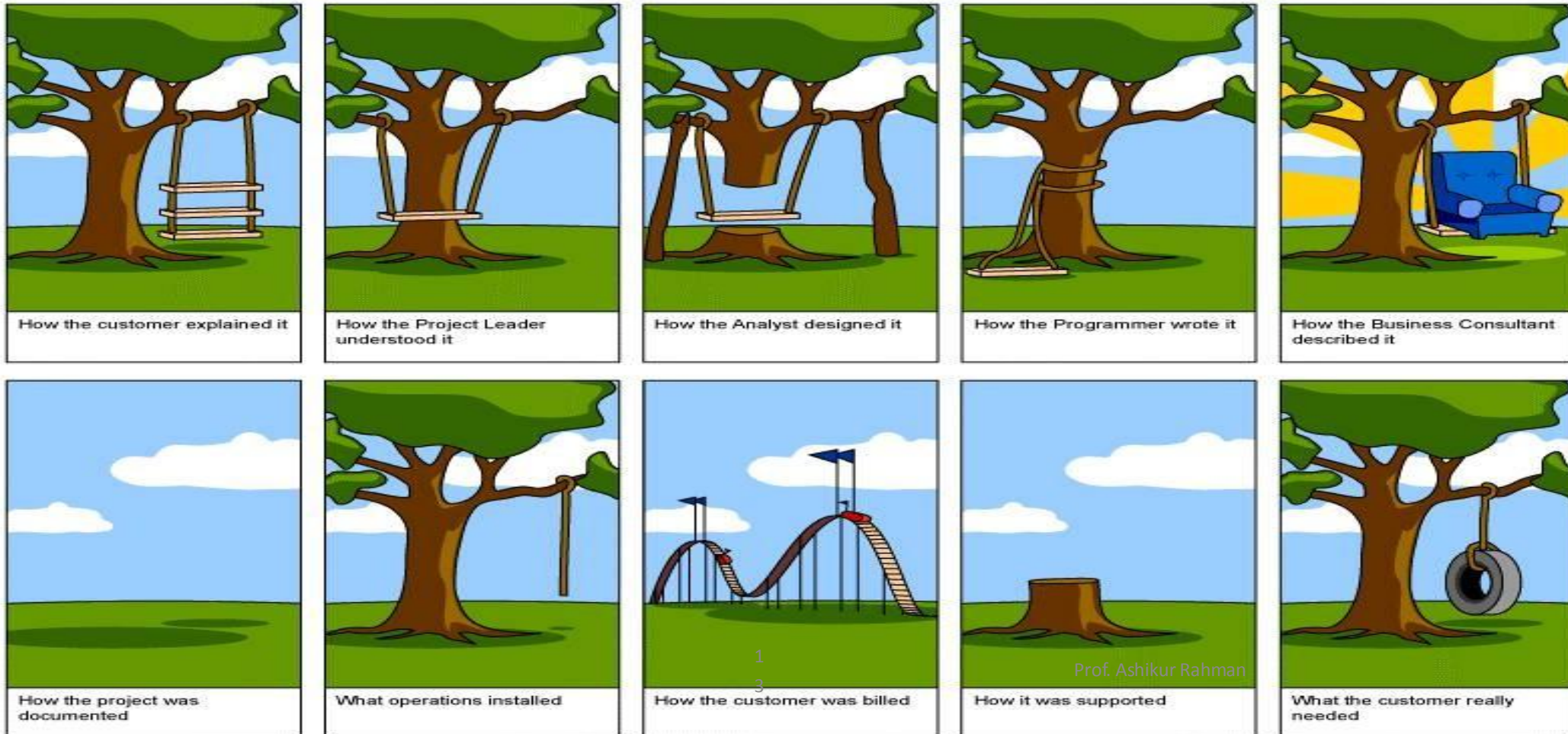
Requirements Types

Development Process

## What is the right system to build ?



# What is the right system to build ?



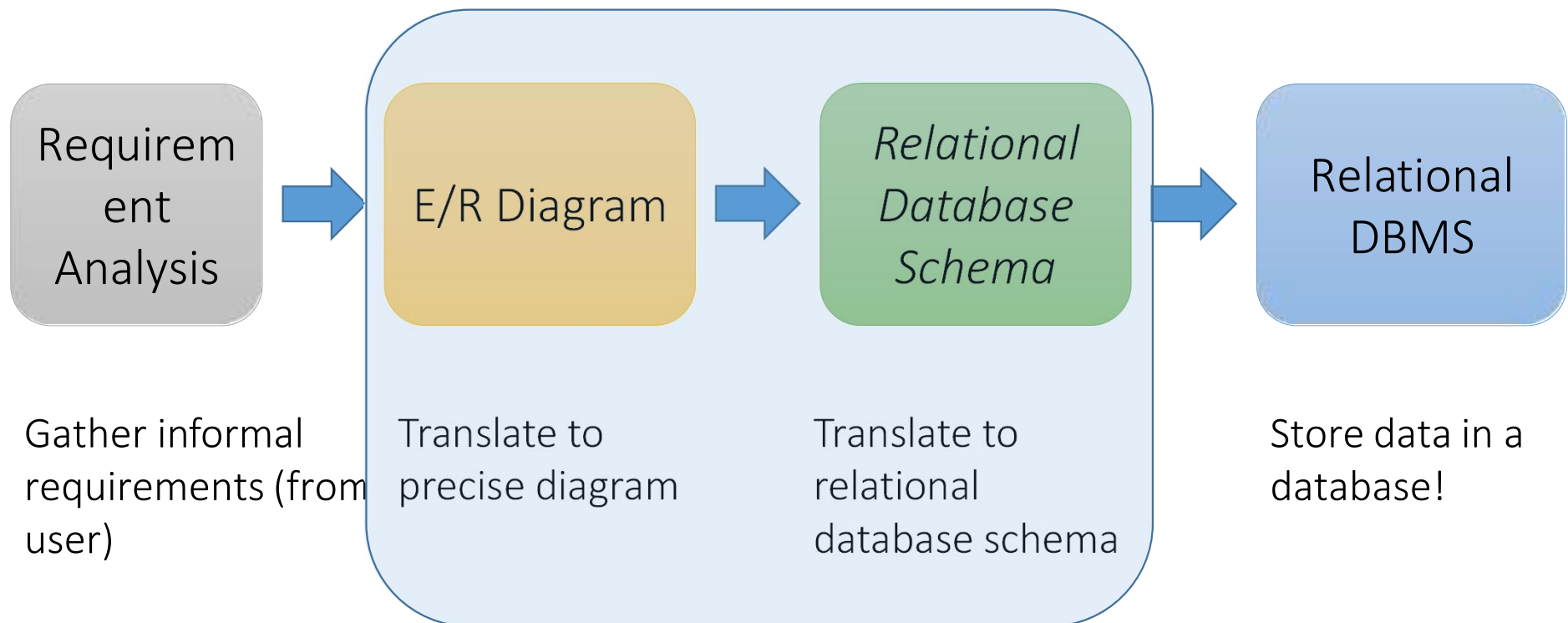
# Requirement Analysis: Example



- For actors and directors, we want to store their name, a unique identification number, address and birthday (why not age?)
- For actors, we also want to store a photograph
- For films, we want to store the title, year of production and type (thriller, comedy, etc.)
- We want to know who directed and who acted in each film. Every film has one director. We store the salary of each actor for each film
- Etc...

## Next Step: E/R modeling

- **Goal** of modeling is to translate informal requirements to a precise diagram. This diagram can then be translated into the desired **data model**, to allow data to be stored in a database



# Interlude: Impact of the ER model

- The E/R model is one of the most cited articles in Computer Science

- *“The Entity-Relationship model – toward a unified view of data”* Peter Chen, 1976

[https://citeseerx.ist.psu.edu › viewdoc › download PDF](https://citeseerx.ist.psu.edu/viewdoc/download?pdf=1)

[The Entity-Relationship Model-Toward a Unified ... - CiteSeerX](#)

by PPINS CHEN · 1976 · Cited by 12756 — A data model, called the entity-relationship model, is proposed. This model incorporates some of the important semantic information...

- Used by companies big and small
  - You'll know it soon enough





# Basic Concepts: Entities, Attributes, Relationships

# Entities and Entity Sets

- **Entity**: An object in the world that can be distinguished from other objects
- **Entity set**: A set of similar entities.

**Examples:** Entity sets

|         |                                         |
|---------|-----------------------------------------|
| PERSON  | Example : Student, Employee             |
| PLACE   | Example : Country, Branch               |
| OBJECT  | Example : Product, Building             |
| EVENT   | Example : Student Registration, Payment |
| CONCEPT | Example : Course, Order                 |

# Entities and Entity Sets

- **Entity set** → Class or type
  - **Nouns** in the problem domain → entity sets
- **Entity** → Object of a class
- Only Entity sets are modeled and not the entities
- Entity sets are drawn as rectangles in the E/R diagram

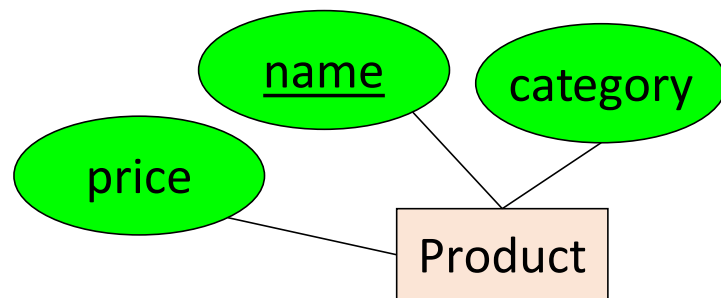
Product

Person

These represent entity sets

# Attributes

- **Attributes** → Used to describe an entity
- All entities in the set have the same attributes
- An attribute contains single piece of information (and not a list of data)
- Attributes are represented by ovals attached to an entity set

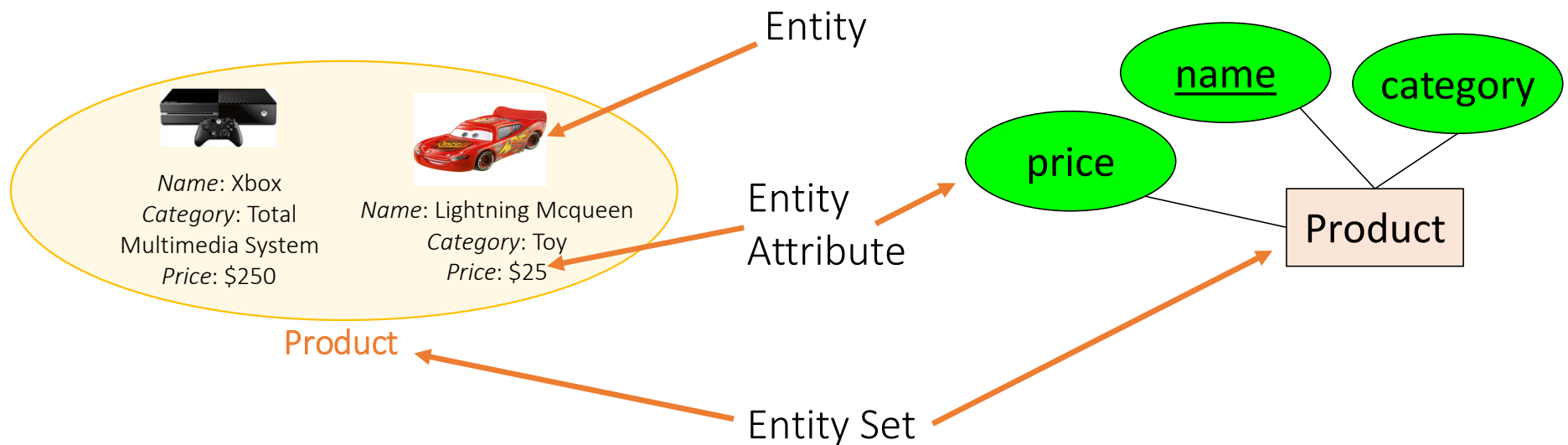


Shapes are important. Colors are not.

# Entities, Entity Sets and Attributes

*Example:*

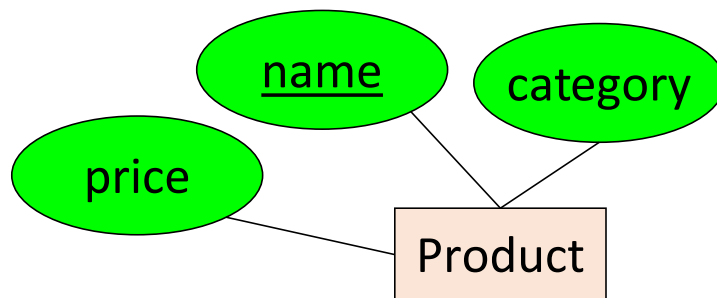
Entities are not explicitly represented in E/R diagrams!



# Keys

- A key is a **minimal** set of attributes that uniquely identifies an entity.

Denote elements of the primary key by underlining.

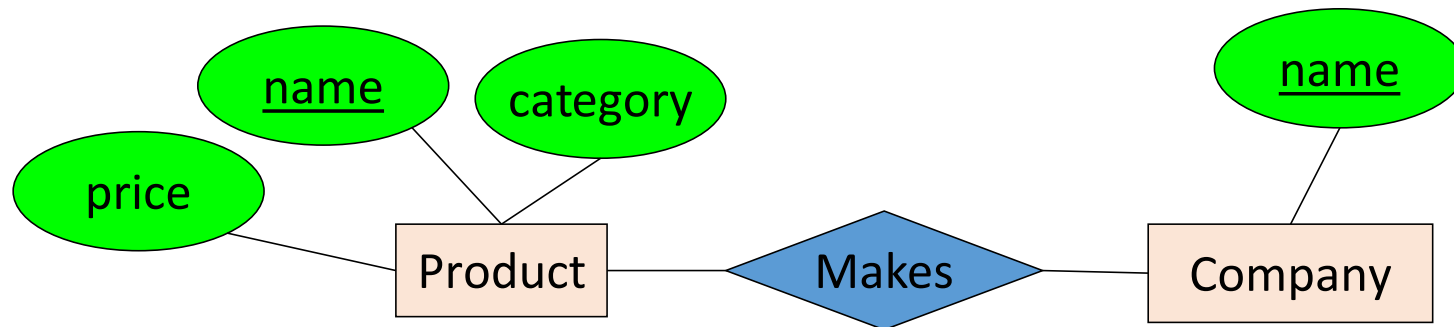


Here, {name, category} is not a key (it is not *minimal*).

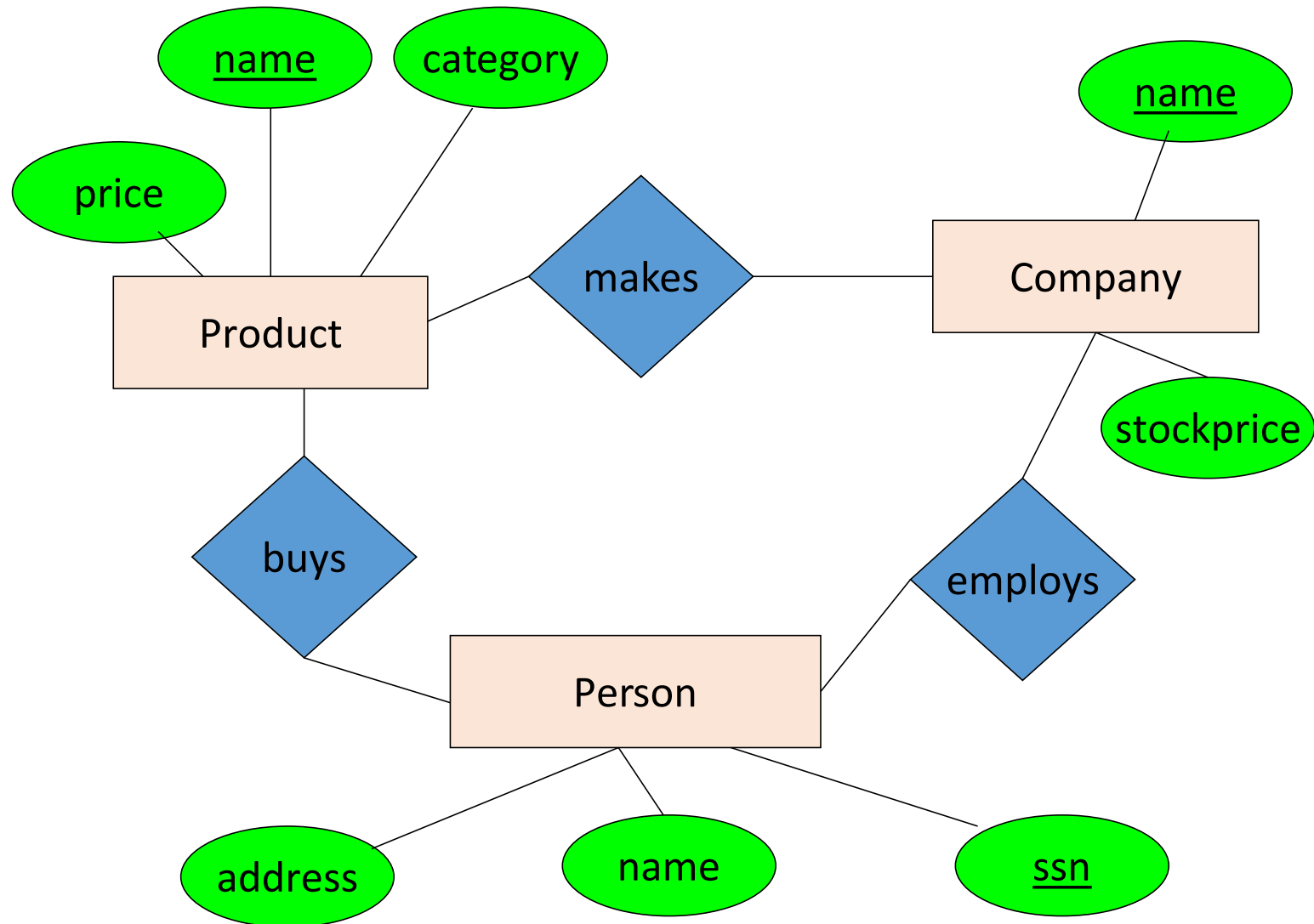
The E/R model forces us to designate a single primary key, though there may be multiple candidate keys

# The R in E/R Diagram: Relationships

- A **relationship** is association among two or more entities
- Relationships are drawn using diamond



- **Verbs** in the problem domain → relationship or relationship set

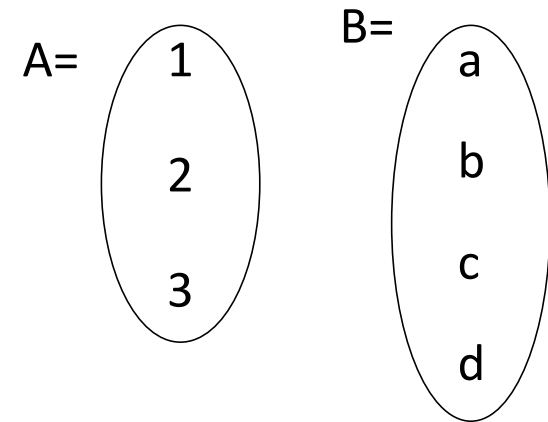




# What is a Relationship?

- ***A mathematical definition:***

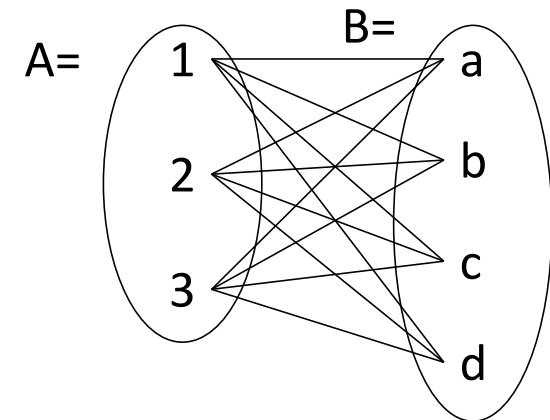
- Let A, B be sets
  - $A=\{1,2,3\}$ ,  $B=\{a,b,c,d\}$



# What is a Relationship?

- ***A mathematical definition:***

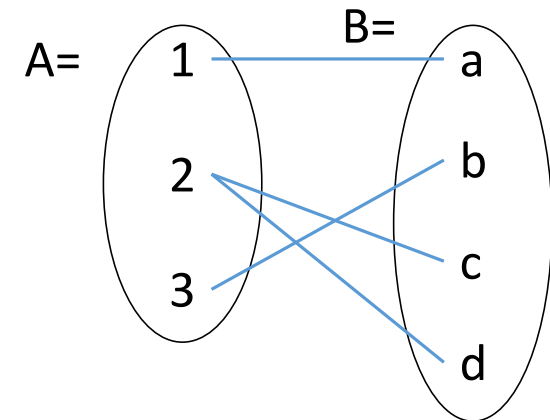
- Let A, B be sets
  - $A = \{1, 2, 3\}$ ,  $B = \{a, b, c, d\}$
- $A \times B$  (the ***cross-product***) is the set of all pairs (a,b)
  - $A \times B = \{(1,a), (1,b), (1,c), (1,d), (2,a), (2,b), (2,c), (2,d), (3,a), (3,b), (3,c), (3,d)\}$



# What is a Relationship?

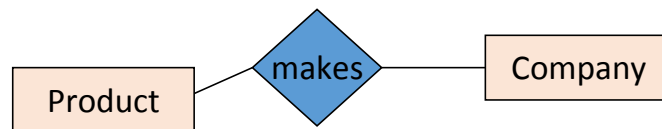
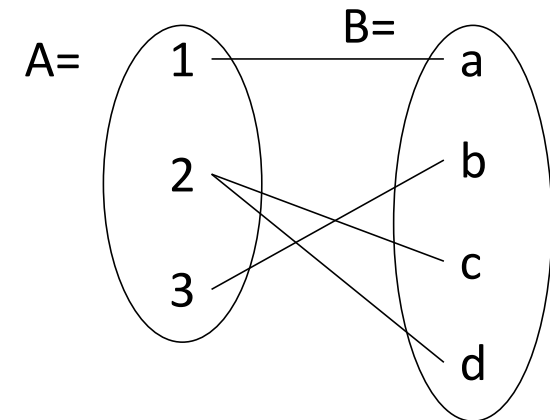
- ***A mathematical definition:***

- Let A, B be sets
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- $A \times B$  (the ***cross-product***) is the set of all pairs (a,b)
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- We define a relationship to be a subset of  $A \times B$ 
  - $R = \{(1,a), (2,c), (2,d), (3,b)\}$

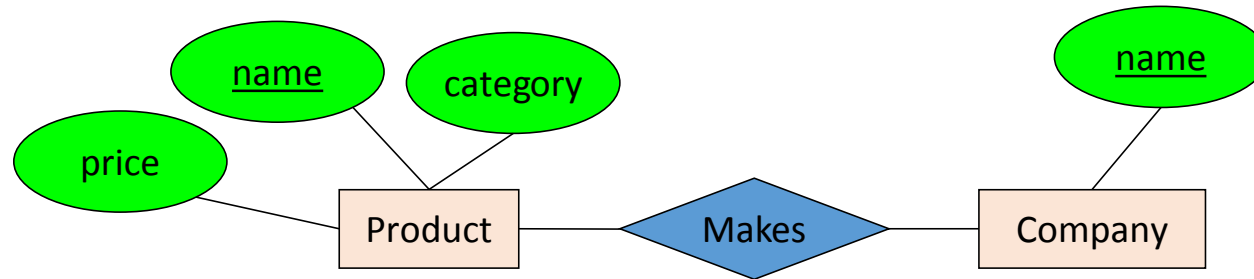


# What is a Relationship?

- ***A mathematical definition:***
  - Let A, B be sets
  - $A \times B$  (the ***cross-product***) is the set of all pairs
  - A relationship is a subset of  $A \times B$
- **Makes** is a relationship-it is a ***subset*** of **Product  $\times$  Company**:



# What is a Relationship?



A relationship between entity sets  $P$  and  $C$  is a *subset of all possible pairs of entities in  $P$  and  $C$* , with tuples uniquely identified by  $P$  and  $C$ 's keys

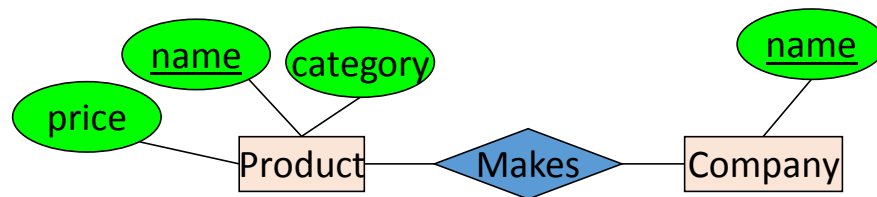
# What is a Relationship?

**Company**

| <u>name</u> |
|-------------|
| GizmoWorks  |
| GadgetCorp  |

**Product**

| <u>name</u> | category    | price  |
|-------------|-------------|--------|
| Gizmo       | Electronics | \$9.99 |
| GizmoLite   | Electronics | \$7.50 |
| Gadget      | Toys        | \$5.50 |



A relationship between entity sets  $P$  and  $C$  is a *subset of all possible pairs of entities in  $P$  and  $C$* , with tuples uniquely identified by  $P$  and  $C$ 's keys

# What is a Relationship?

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|-------------|
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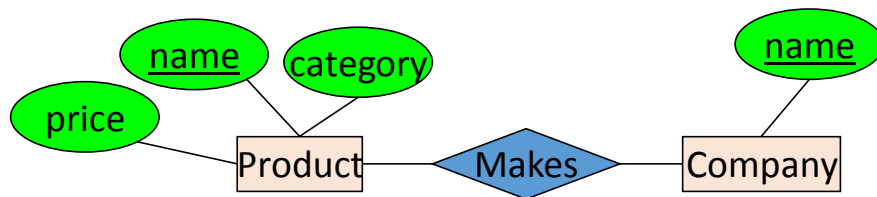
Product

| <u>name</u> | category    | price  |
|-------------|-------------|--------|
| Gizmo       | Electronics | \$9.99 |
| GizmoLite   | Electronics | \$7.50 |
| Gadget      | Toys        | \$5.50 |



Company C × Product P

| <u>C.name</u> | <u>P.name</u> | P.category  | P.price |
|---------------|---------------|-------------|---------|
| GizmoWorks    | Gizmo         | Electronics | \$9.99  |
| GizmoWorks    | GizmoLite     | Electronics | \$7.50  |
| GizmoWorks    | Gadget        | Toys        | \$5.50  |
| GadgetCorp    | Gizmo         | Electronics | \$9.99  |
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A relationship between entity sets P and C is a *subset of all possible pairs of entities in P and C*, with tuples uniquely identified by P and C's keys

# What is a Relationship?

Company

| <u>name</u> |
|-------------|
| GizmoWorks  |
| GadgetCorp  |

Product

| <u>name</u> | category    | price  |
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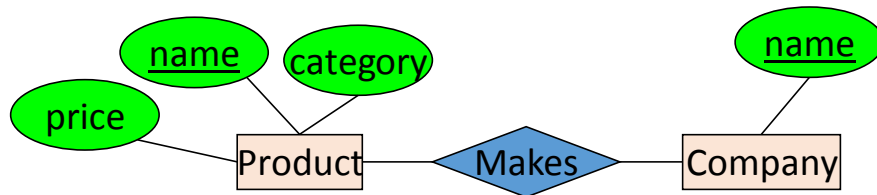
Company C × Product P

| <u>C.name</u> | <u>P.name</u> | P.category  | P.price |
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| GadgetCorp    | GizmoLite     | Electronics | \$7.50  |
| GadgetCorp    | Gadget        | Toys        | \$5.50  |



Makes

| <u>C.name</u> | <u>P.name</u> |
|---------------|---------------|
| GizmoWorks    | Gizmo         |
| GizmoWorks    | GizmoLite     |
| GadgetCorp    | Gadget        |



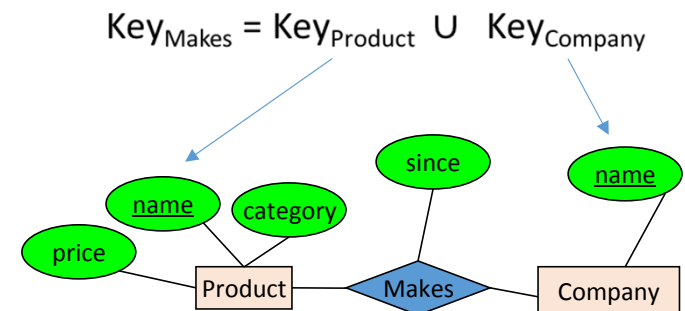
A relationship between entity sets P and C is a *subset of all possible pairs of entities in P and C*, with tuples uniquely identified by P and C's keys



# What is a Relationship?

- There can only be **one relationship for every unique combination of entities**
- This also means that **the relationship is uniquely determined by the keys of its entities**
- *Example: the key for Makes (to right) is  $\{Product.name, Company.name\}$*

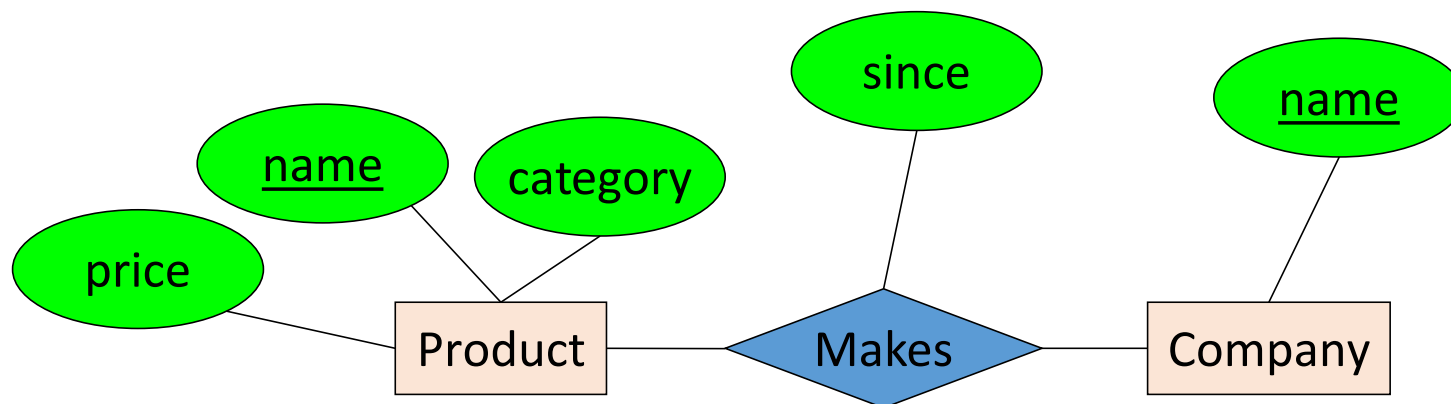
This follows from our mathematical definition of a relationship- it's a SET!



Why does this make sense?

# Relationships and Attributes

- Relationships may have attributes as well.



For example: “since” records when company started making a product

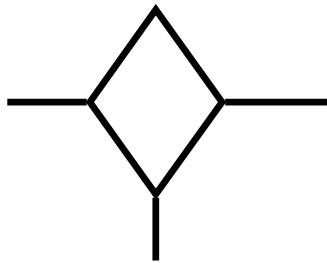
Note: “since” is implicitly unique per pair here! Why?

Note #2: Why not “how long”?

# Tools at a glance



**Entities ('entity sets')**



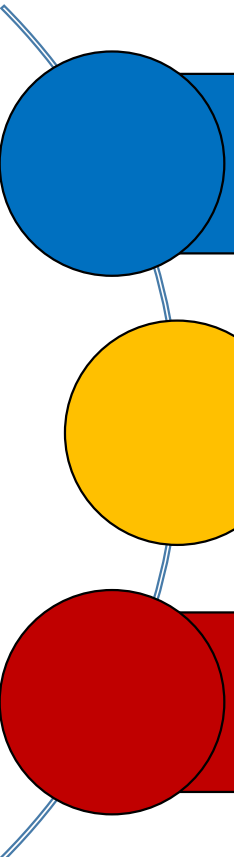
**Relationships ('rel. sets') and mapping constraints**



**Attributes**

## 2. E/R Design Considerations

# What you will learn in this section



Relationships cont'd: multiplicity, multi-way

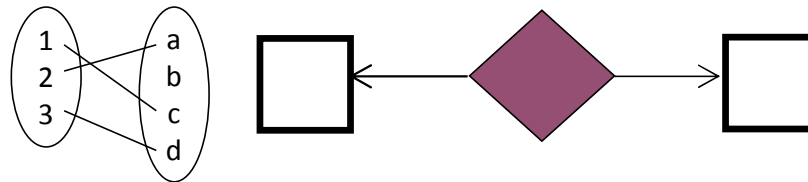
Design considerations

Conversion to SQL

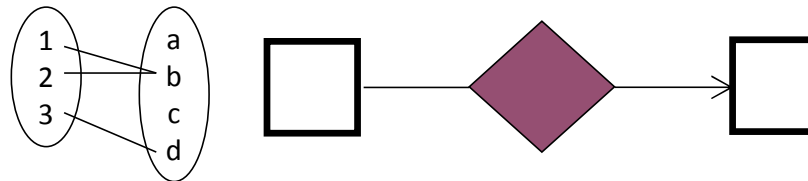
# Multiplicity of E/R Relationships

# Multiplicity of E/R Relationships

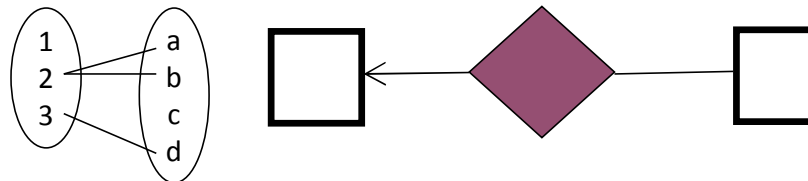
One-to-one:



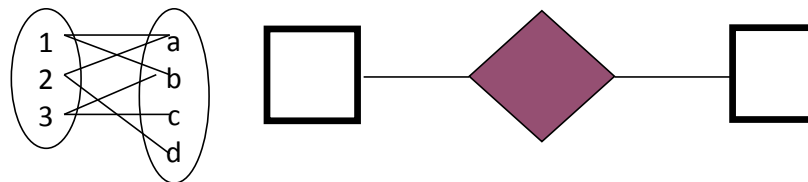
Many-to-one:



One-to-many:



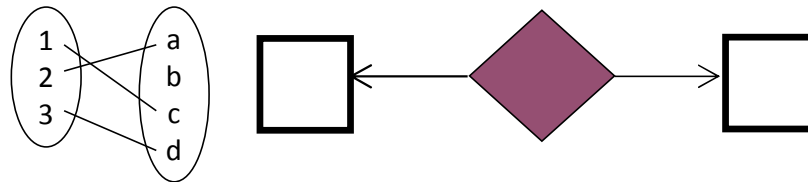
Many-to-many:



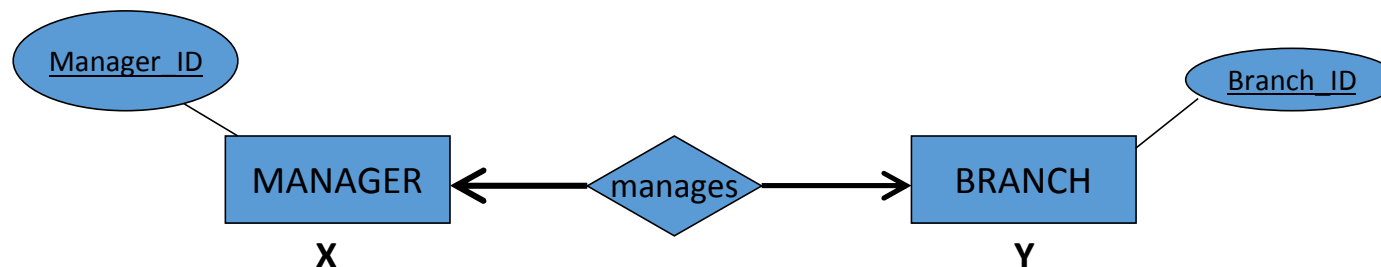
Indicated using  
arrows

## Example: One to One Relationships (1:1)

One-to-one:



Def : Maximum one X for each Y and one Y for each X

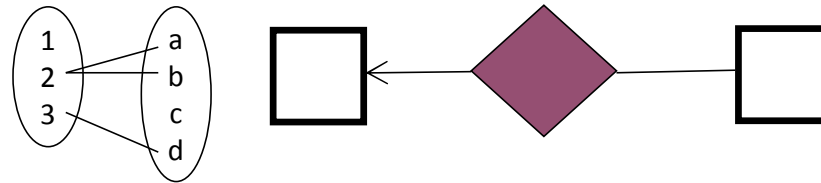


**An employee (manager) can manage only one branch at one time and each branch has only one manager.**

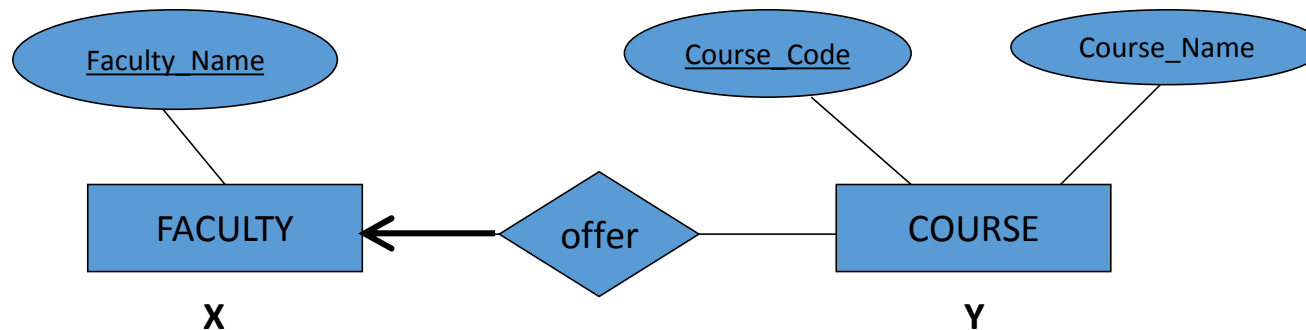


## Example: One to Many Relationships (1:M)

One-to-many:



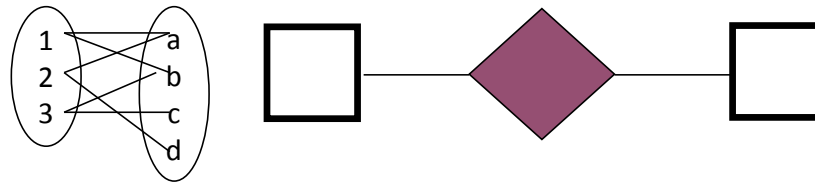
Def : Maximum one X for each Y but possibly many Y for each X



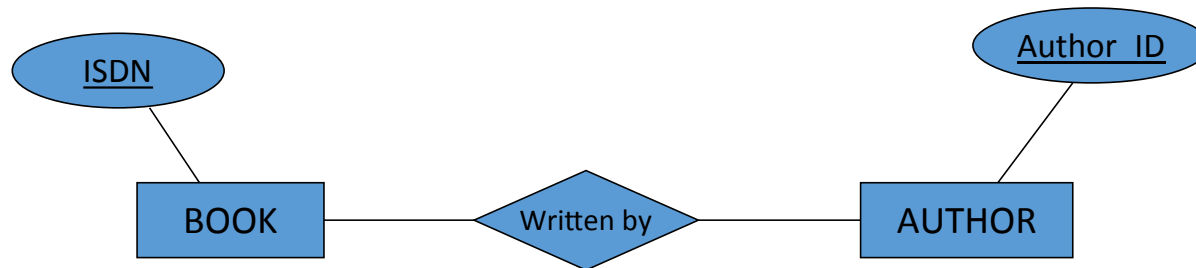
**At university, one faculty offers many courses for students but one course is offered by one faculty only.**

## Example: Many to Many Relationships (M:N)

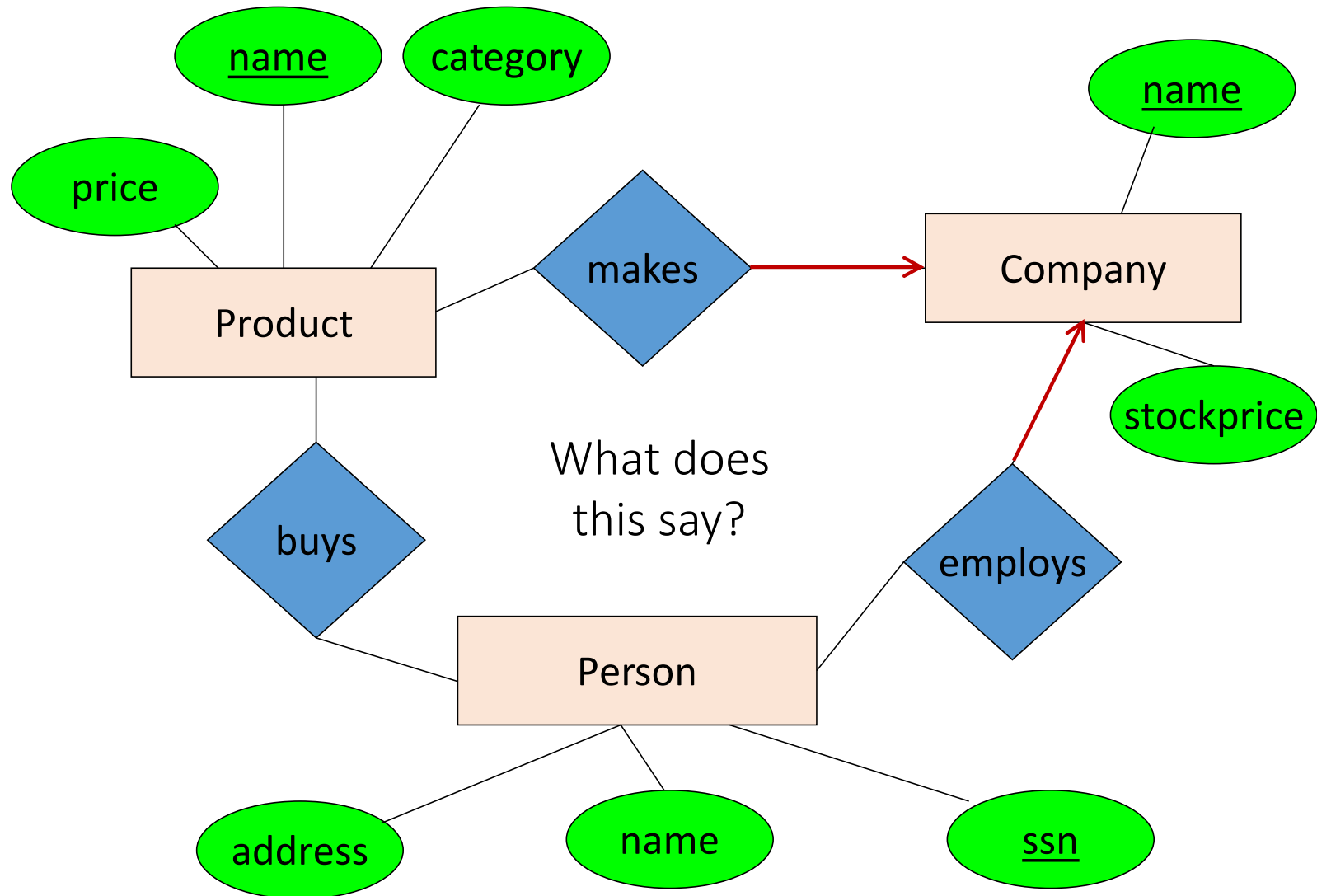
Many-to-many:



Def : Possibly many X's for each Y and many Y's for each X

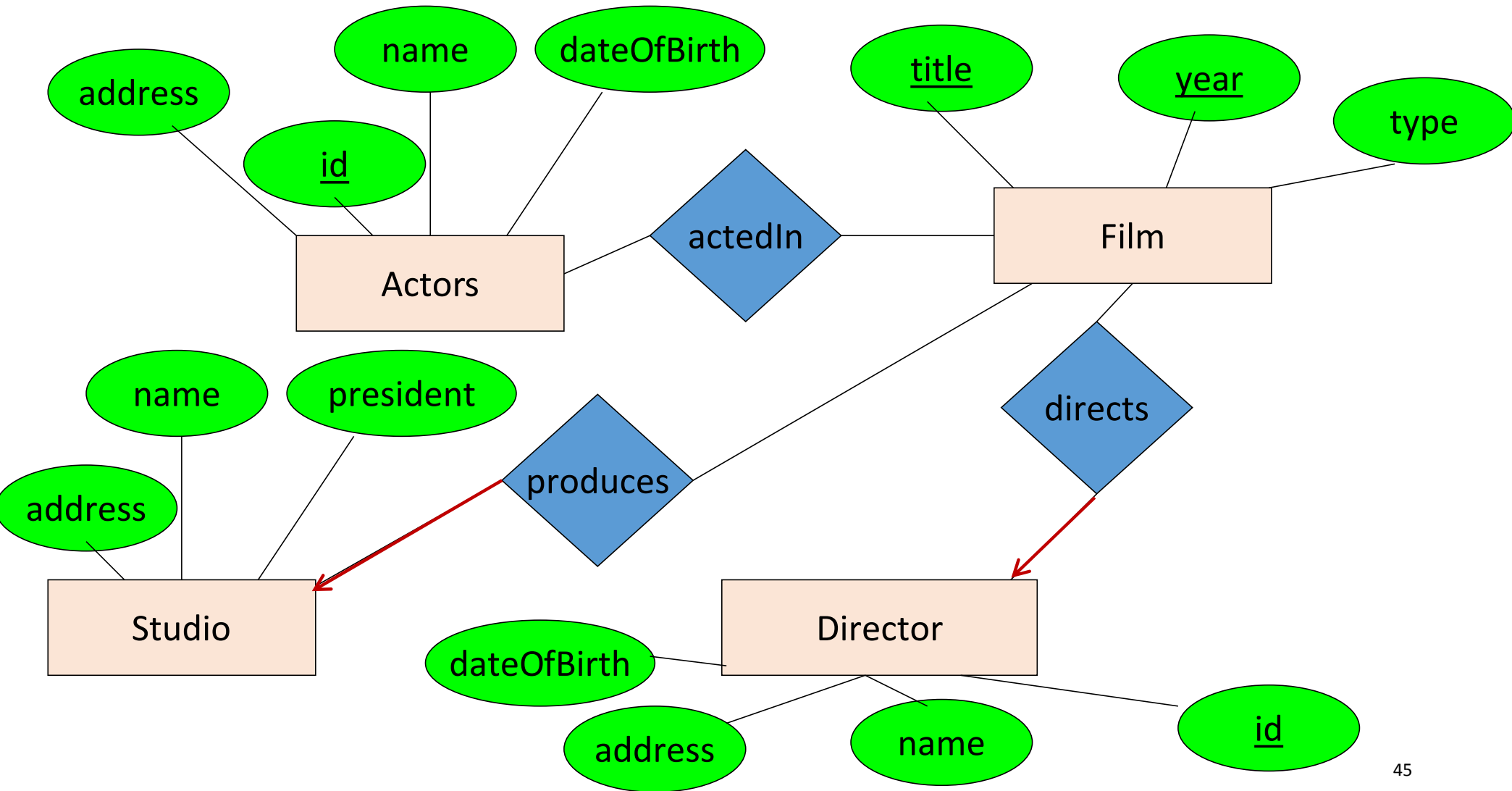


**A book may have more than one author and an author may write more than one book.**

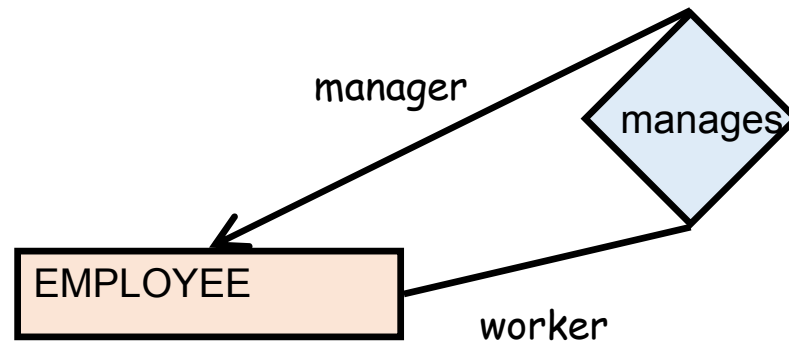


# Activity in the class

- For actors and directors, we want to store their name, a unique identification number, address and birthday (why not age?)
- For films, we want to store the title, year of production and type (thriller, comedy, etc.)
- We want to know who directed and who acted in each film. Every film has one director. We store the salary of each actor for each film
- For Studio we want to store name, address and name of its president. A movie can be produced by only one studio.



# Self Relationships or Recursive Relationships

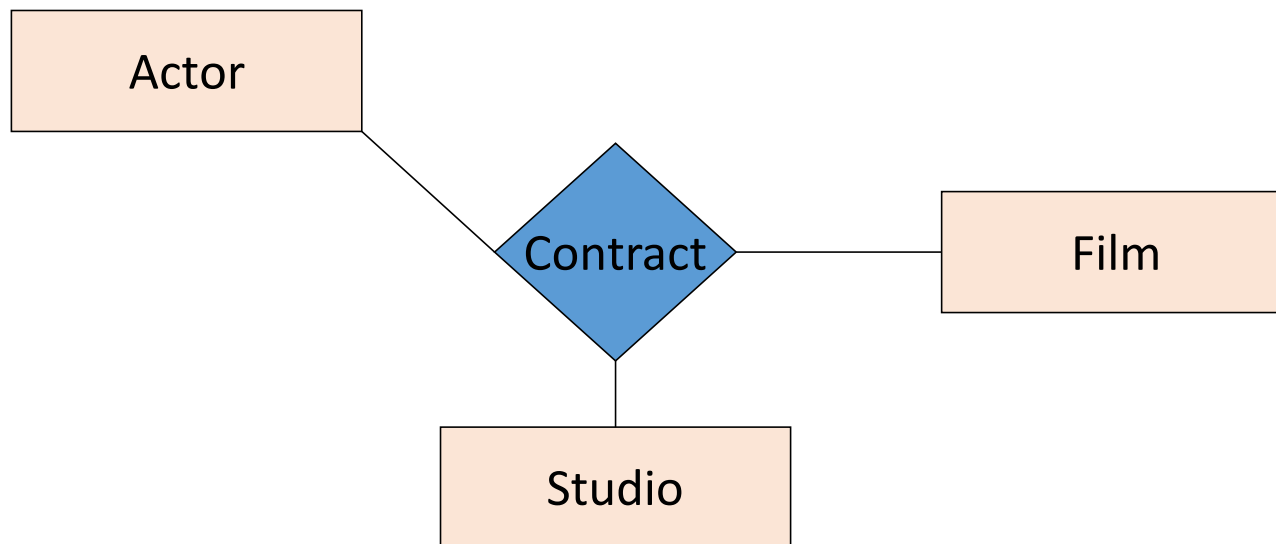


# Multi-way Relationships



# Multi-way Relationships

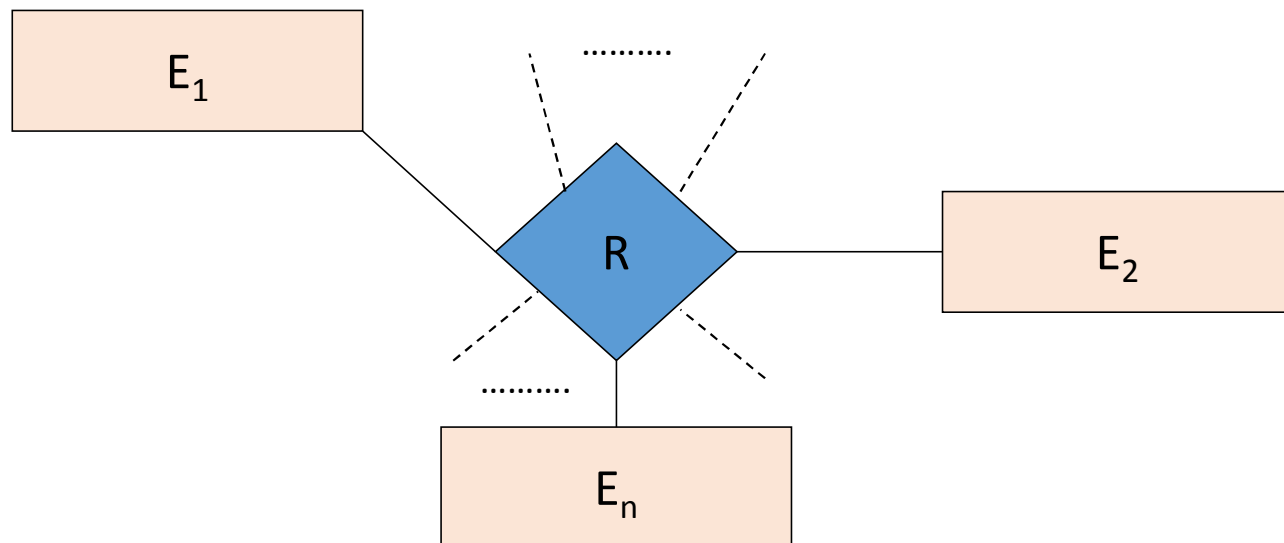
How do we model that a studio has made a contract with a particular actor to act in a particular movie?



NB: Can still model as a mathematical set (how?)

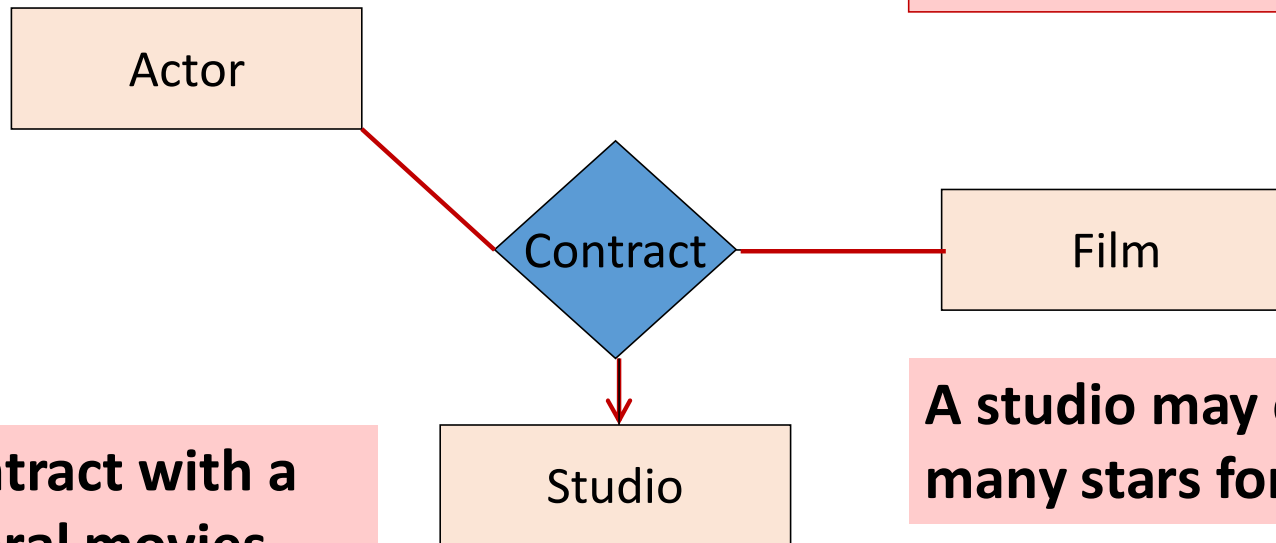
## Formal mathematical definition

- An  $n$ -ary relationship set  $R$  involves exactly  $n$  entity sets:  $E_1, \dots, E_n$ .
- Each relationship in  $R$  involves exactly  $n$  entities:  $e_1$  in  $E_1, \dots, e_n$  in  $E_n$
- Formally,  $R \subseteq E_1 \times \dots \times E_n$



# Arrows in Multiway Relationships

Q: What does the arrow mean ?



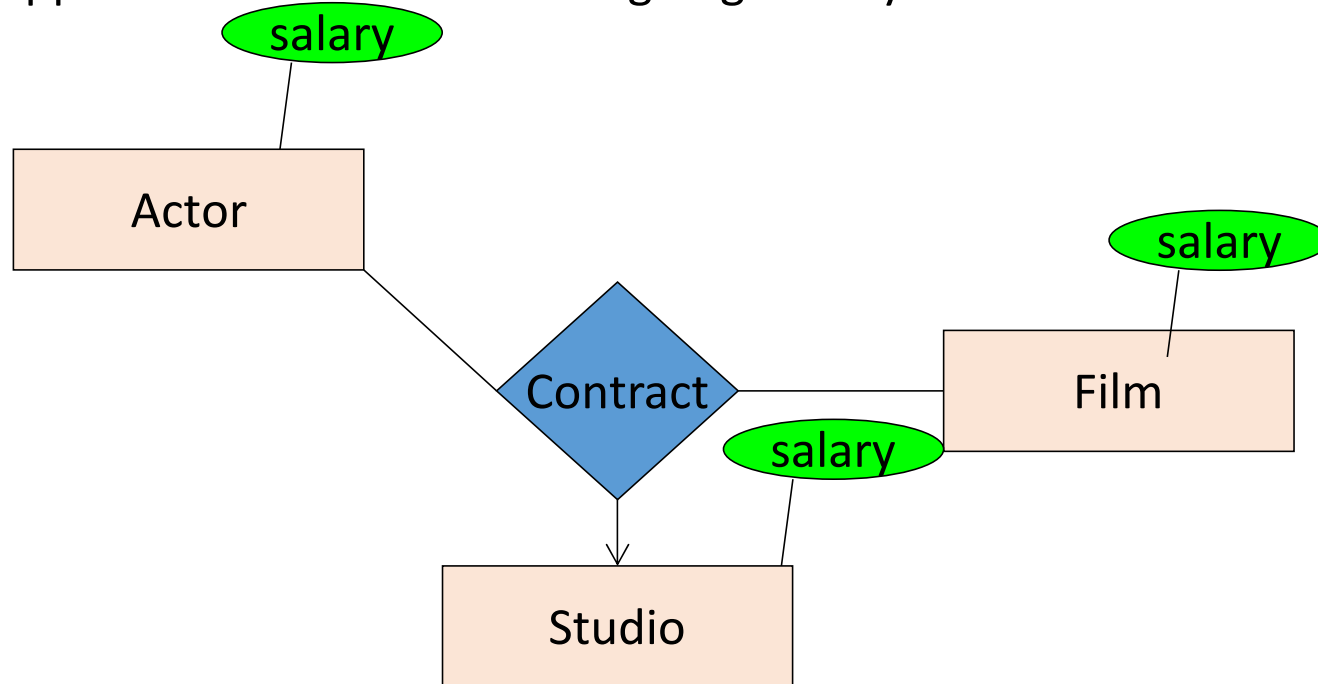
**For a particular star and movie there is only one studio under the contract**

**A star may contract with a studio for several movies**

**A studio may contract with many stars for a movie**

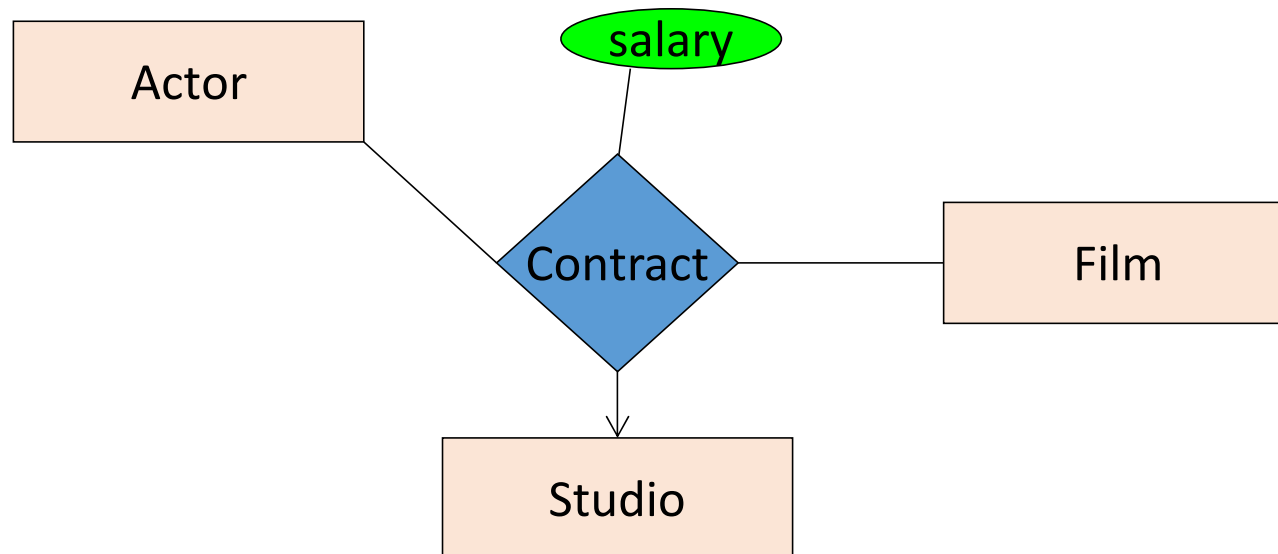
# Attributes in Relationships

**Q:** Suppose we want to add the signing money information. Where do we put?

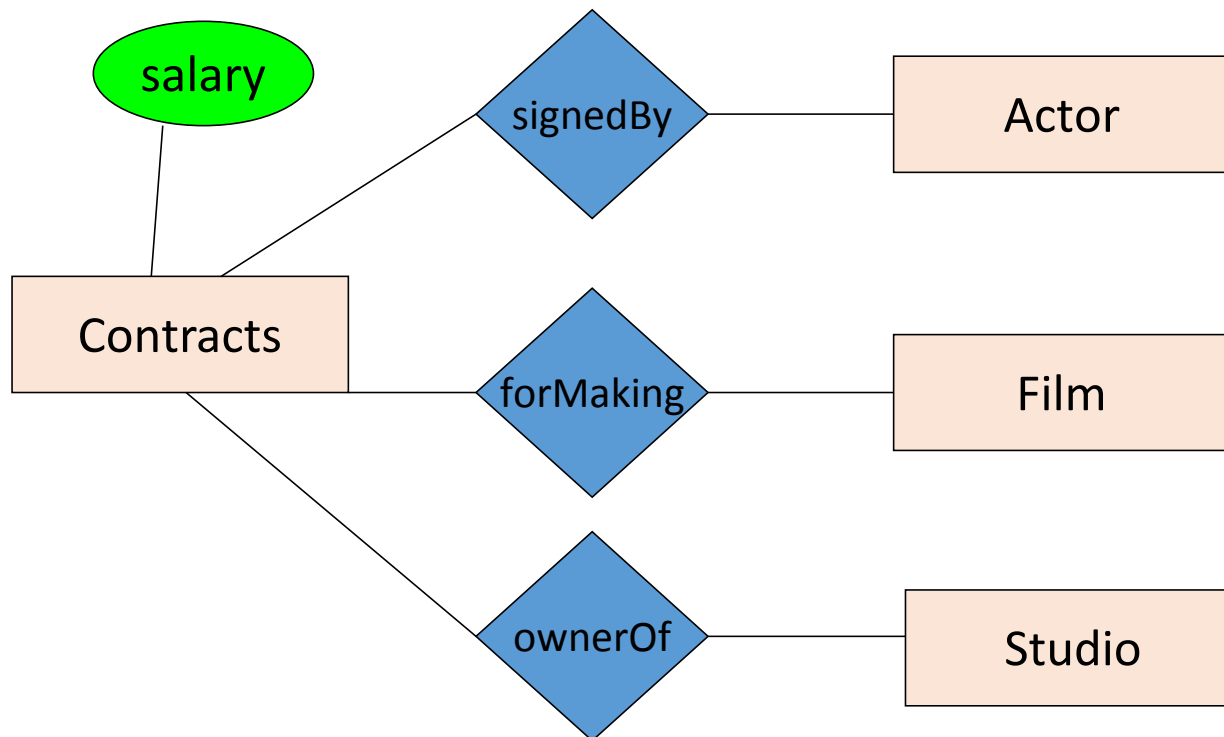


# Attributes in Relationships: The correct way

**Q:** Suppose we want to add the signing money information. Where do we put?

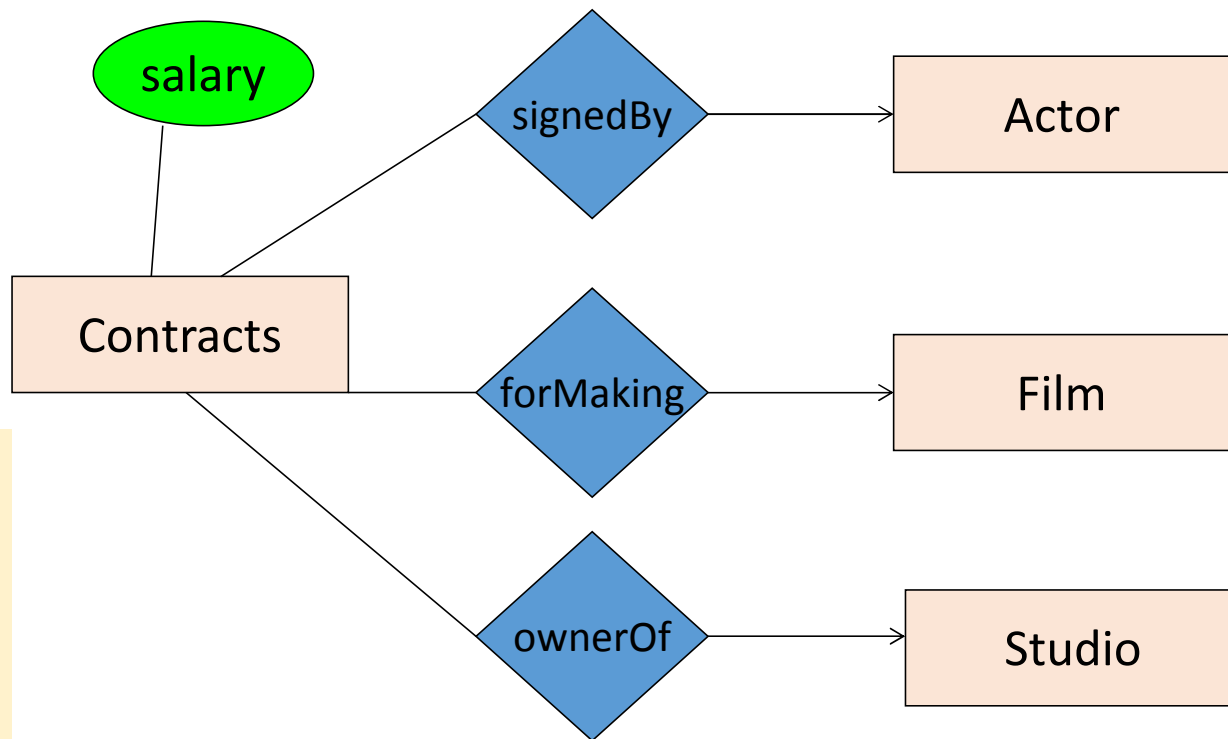


## Converting Multi-way Relationships to Binary Relations



From what we had on previous slide to this - what did we do?

# Converting Multi-way Relationships to New Entity + Binary Relationships



Side note:  
What arrows  
should be  
added here?  
Are these  
correct?

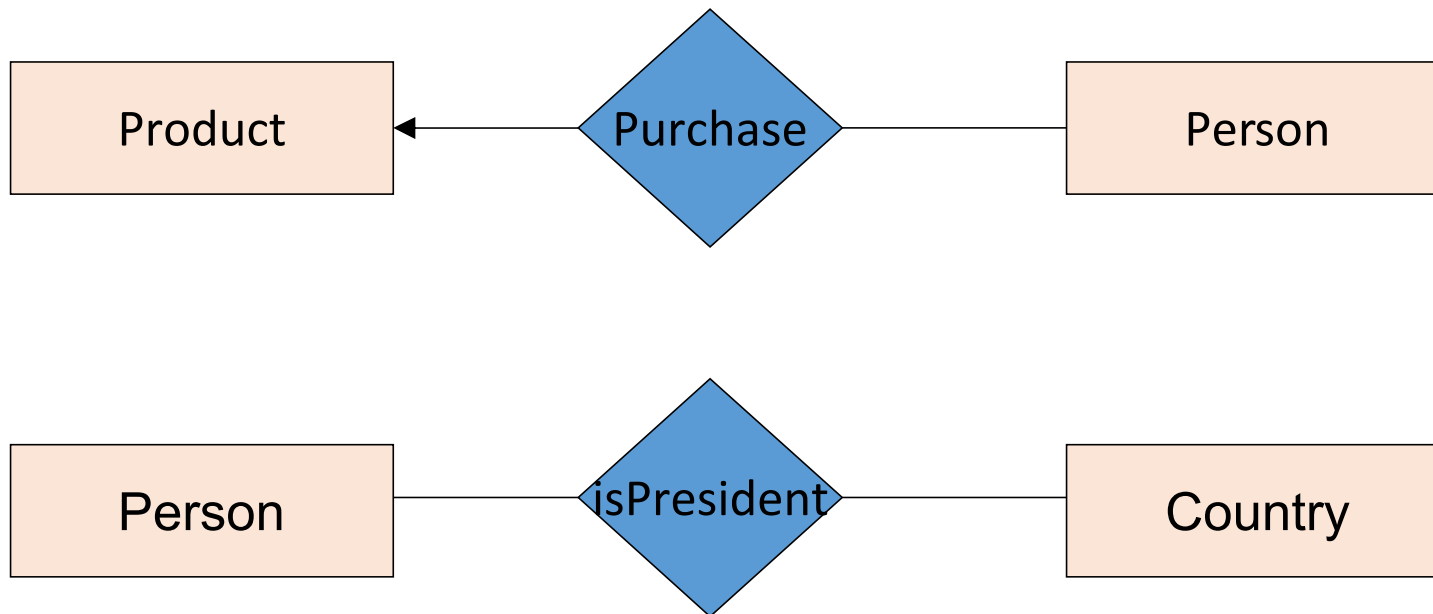
For a particular contract there can be only one star, one movie and one studio. But an actor or a movie or a studio may have several contracts

# 3. Design Principles



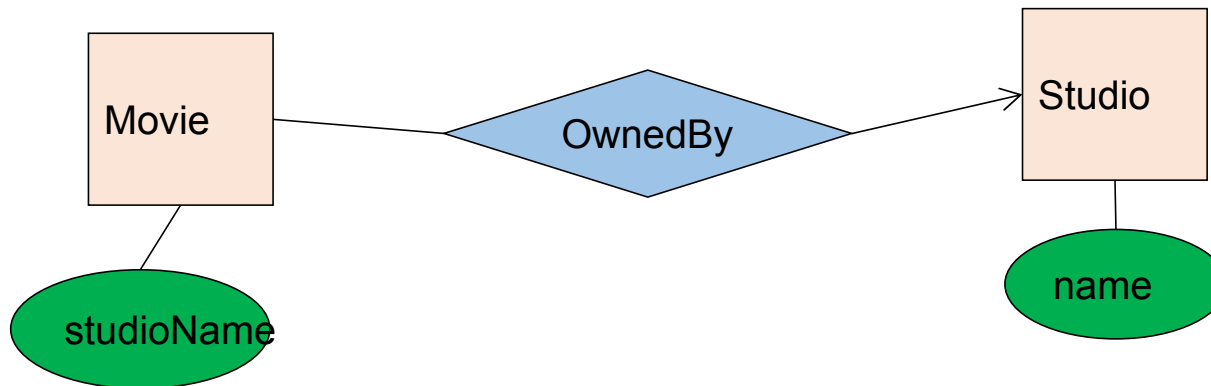
# Design Principles

What's wrong with these examples?



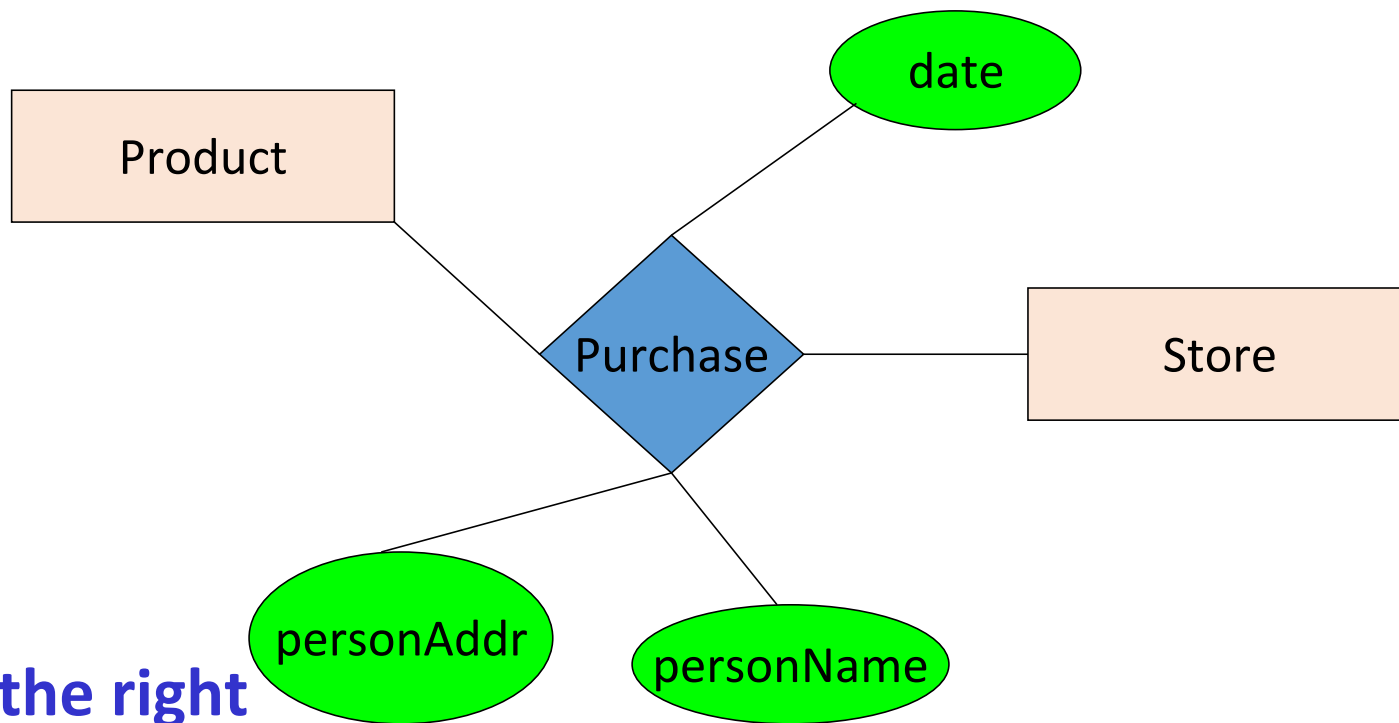
**Moral: be faithful!**

# Design Principles: What's Wrong?



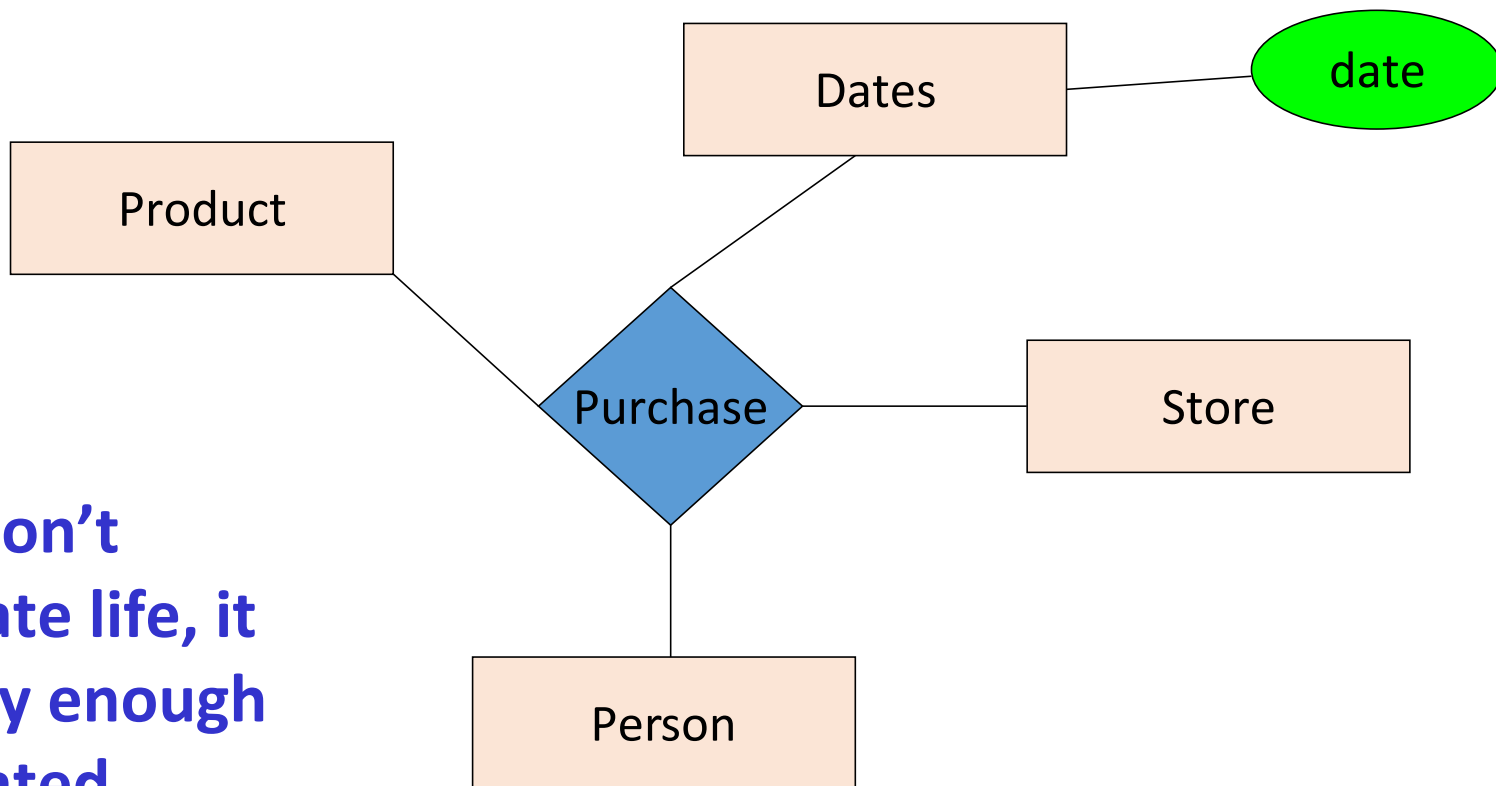
**Moral: should not model the same information in multiple ways**

# Design Principles: What's Wrong?



**Moral: pick the right  
kind of elements (entities/relationships).**

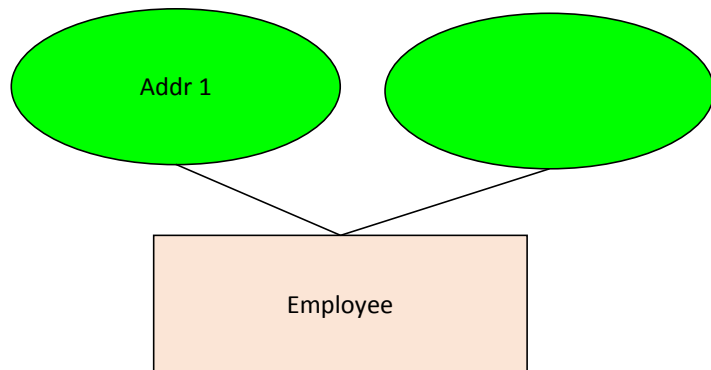
# Design Principles: What's Wrong?



**Moral: don't  
complicate life, it  
is already enough  
complicated.**

# Design Principles: Entity vs. Attribute

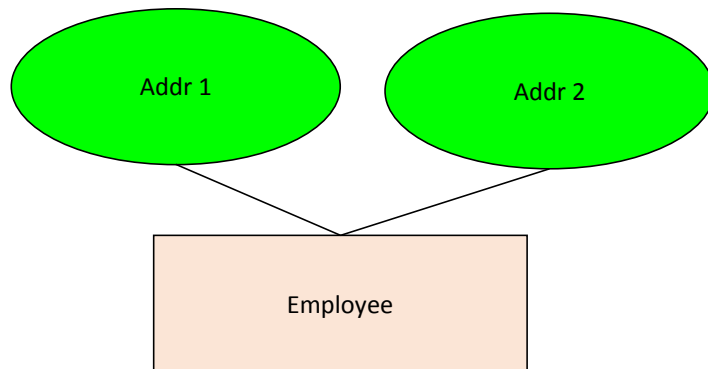
How do we handle employees with multiple addresses here?



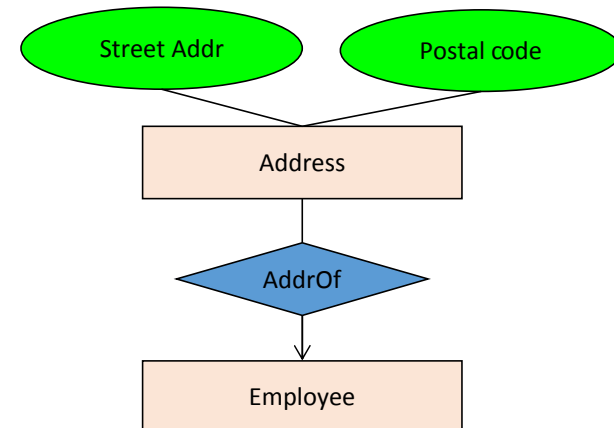
How do we handle addresses where internal structure of the address (e.g. postal code, city, division) is useful?

# Design Principles: Entity vs. Attribute

Should address (A)  
be an attribute?



Or (B) be an entity?



In general, when we want to record several values,  
we choose new entity

# From E/R Diagrams to Relational Schema

# From E/R Diagrams to Relational Schema

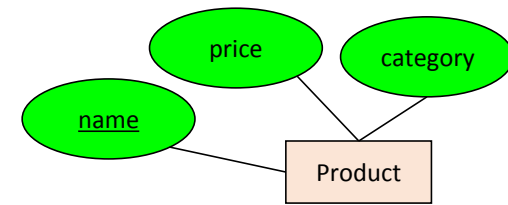
- Key concept:

Both ***Entity sets*** and ***Relationships*** become relations (tables in RDBMS)



# From E/R Diagrams to Relational Schema

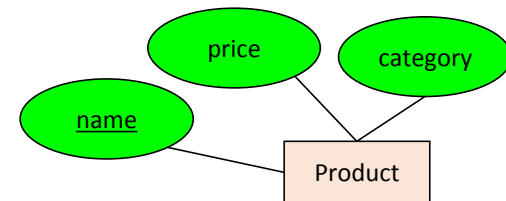
- An entity set becomes a relation (collection of tuples / table)
  - Each tuple is one entity
  - Each tuple is composed of the entity's attributes, and has the same primary key



Product

| <u>name</u> | price | category |
|-------------|-------|----------|
| Gizmo1      | 99.99 | Camera   |
| Gizmo2      | 19.99 | Edible   |

# From E/R Diagrams to Relational Schema



```
CREATE TABLE Product(  
  name CHAR(50) PRIMARY KEY,  
  price FLOAT,  
  category VARCHAR(30)  
)
```



Product

| <u>name</u> | price | category |
|-------------|-------|----------|
| Gizmo1      | 99.99 | Camera   |
| Gizmo2      | 19.99 | Edible   |

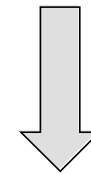
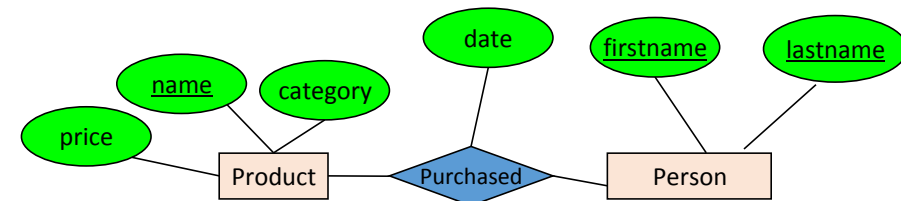
# From E/R Diagrams to Relational Schema

Converting **Many-to-Many** Relationships to Relational Schema

# From E/R Diagrams to Relational Schema

- A relationship between entity sets  $A_1, \dots, A_N$  *also* becomes a set of tuples / a table

- Each row/tuple is one relation, i.e. one unique combination of entities ( $a_1, \dots, a_N$ )
- Each row/tuple is
  - composed of the **union of the entity sets' key attributes**
  - has the entities' primary keys as foreign keys
  - has the union of the entity sets' keys as primary key

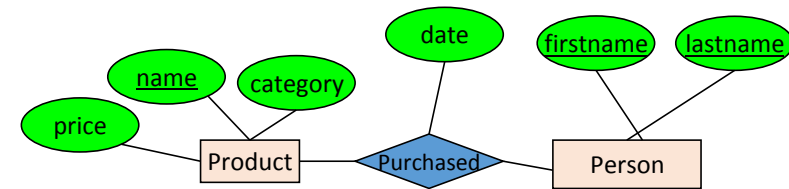


Purchased

| <u>name</u> | <u>firstname</u> | <u>lastname</u> | date     |
|-------------|------------------|-----------------|----------|
| Gizmo1      | Bob              | Joe             | 01/01/15 |
| Gizmo2      | Joe              | Bob             | 01/03/15 |
| Gizmo1      | JoeBob           | Smith           | 01/05/15 |

# From E/R Diagrams to Relational Schema

```
CREATE TABLE Purchased(
  name    CHAR(50),
  firstname CHAR(50),
  lastname CHAR(50),
  date    DATE,
  PRIMARY KEY (name, firstname, lastname),
  FOREIGN KEY (name)
    REFERENCES Product(name),
  FOREIGN KEY (firstname, lastname)
    REFERENCES Person(firstname, lastname)
)
```



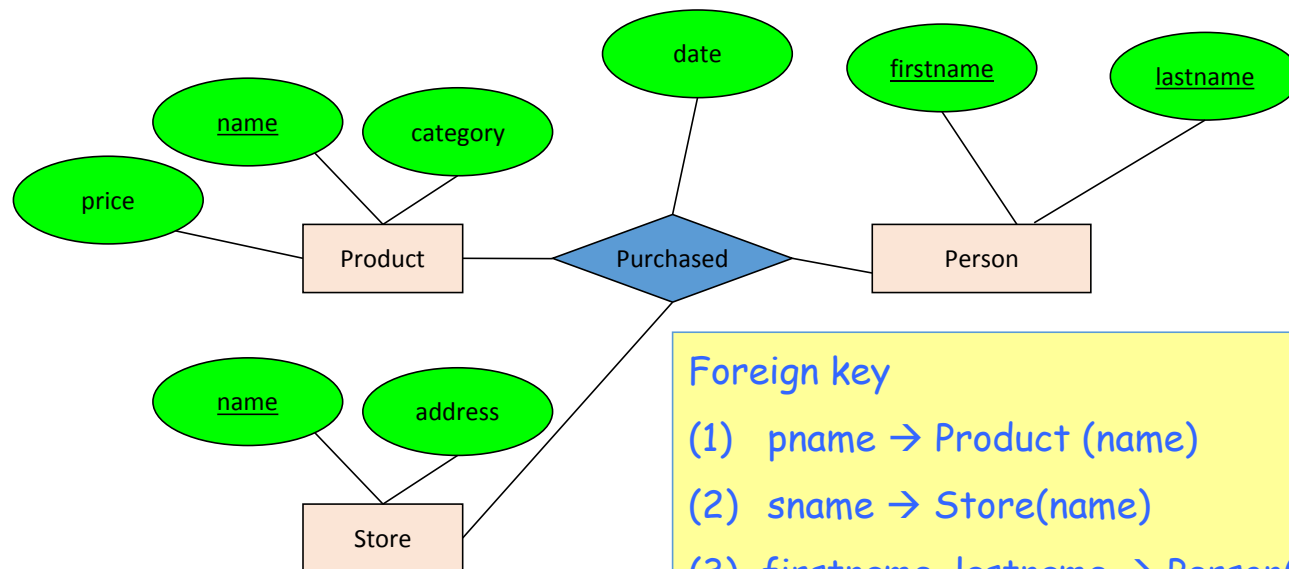
Purchased

| <u>name</u> | <u>firstname</u> | <u>lastname</u> | date     |
|-------------|------------------|-----------------|----------|
| Gizmo1      | Bob              | Joe             | 01/01/15 |
| Gizmo2      | Joe              | Bob             | 01/03/15 |
| Gizmo1      | JoeBob           | Smith           | 01/05/15 |

# From E/R Diagram to Relational Schema

How do we represent this as a relational schema?

Purchased (pname, sname, firstname, lastname, date)



## Foreign key

- (1) pname → Product (name)
- (2) sname → Store(name)
- (3) firstname, lastname → Person(firstname, lastname)

# From E/R Diagrams to Relational Schema

## Converting One-to-Many Relationships to Relational Schema

# From E/R Diagram to Relational Schema

- For many to one relations we have two options:

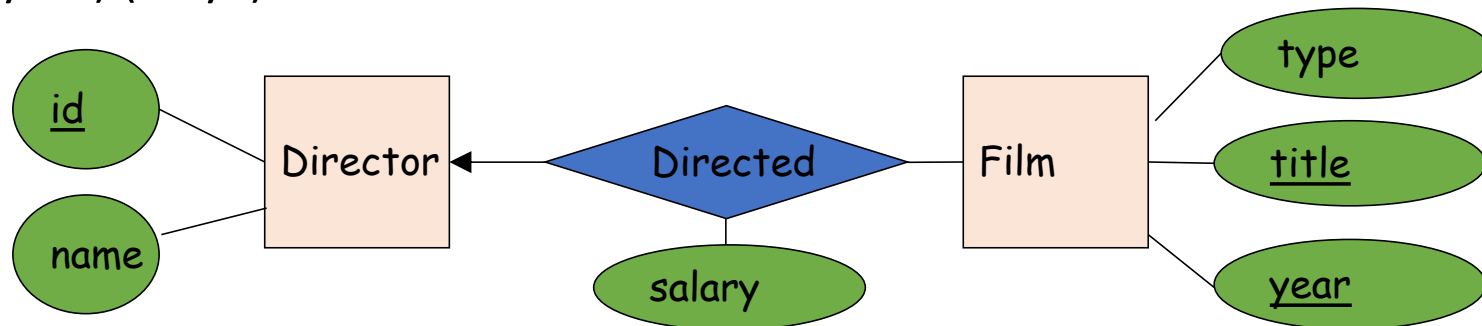
## Option 1:

Same as without key constraints (3 tables), except that the primary key of Directed is now (title, year) (why?)

Film (title, year, type)

Director (id, name)

Directed (title, year, id, salary)





# From E/R Diagram to Relational Schema

```
CREATE TABLE Film(  
  title CHAR(50),  
  year INT,  
  type CHAR(40),  
  PRIMARY KEY (title, year)  
)
```

```
CREATE TABLE Director(  
  id INT,  
  name CHAR(40),  
  PRIMARY KEY (id)  
)
```

Film (title, year, type)

Director (id, name)

Directed (title, year, id, salary)

```
CREATE TABLE Directed(  
  title CHAR(50),  
  year INT,  
  id INT,  
  salary FLOAT,  
  PRIMARY KEY (title, year),  
  FOREIGN KEY (title, year)  
    REFERENCES Film (title, year),  
  FOREIGN KEY (id)  
    REFERENCES Director(id)  
)
```

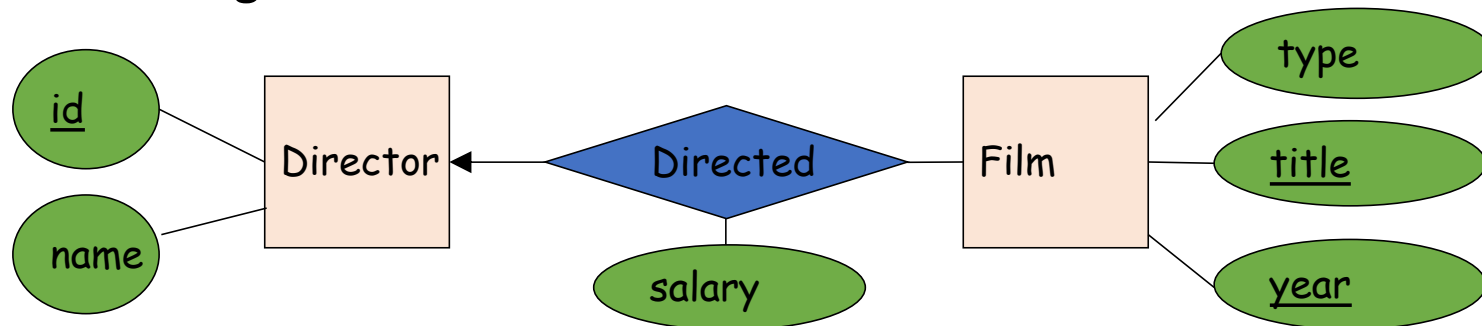
# From E/R Diagram to Relational Schema

## Option 2:

- Do not create a table for the relationship
- Add information columns that would have been in the relationship's relation to the relation of the **entity which does not have the incoming arrow**

Film (title, year, type, id, salary)

Director (id, name)



# From E/R Diagram to Relational Schema

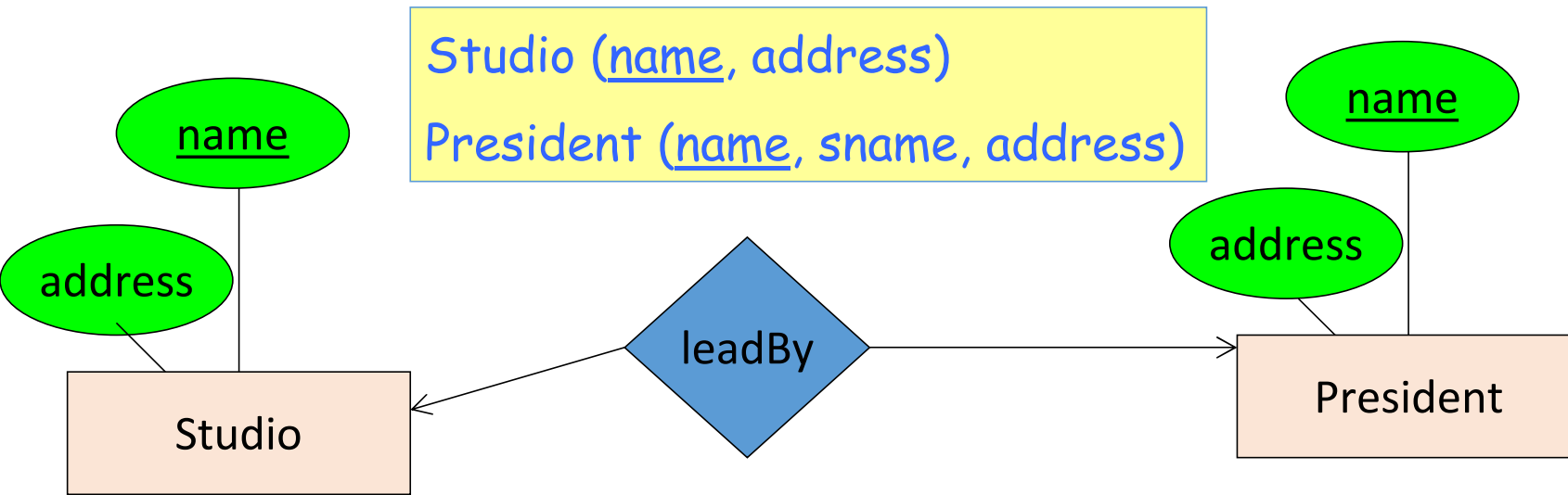
```
CREATE TABLE Film(  
  title   CHAR(50),  
  year    INT,  
  type    CHAR(40),  
  id      INT,  
  salary  FLOAT,  
  PRIMARY KEY (title, year),  
  FOREIGN KEY (id)  
    REFERENCES Director(id)  
)
```

Film (title, year, type, id, salary)  
Director (id, name)

```
CREATE TABLE Director(  
  id      INT,  
  name    CHAR(40),  
  PRIMARY KEY (id)  
)
```

# From E/R Diagrams to Relational Schema

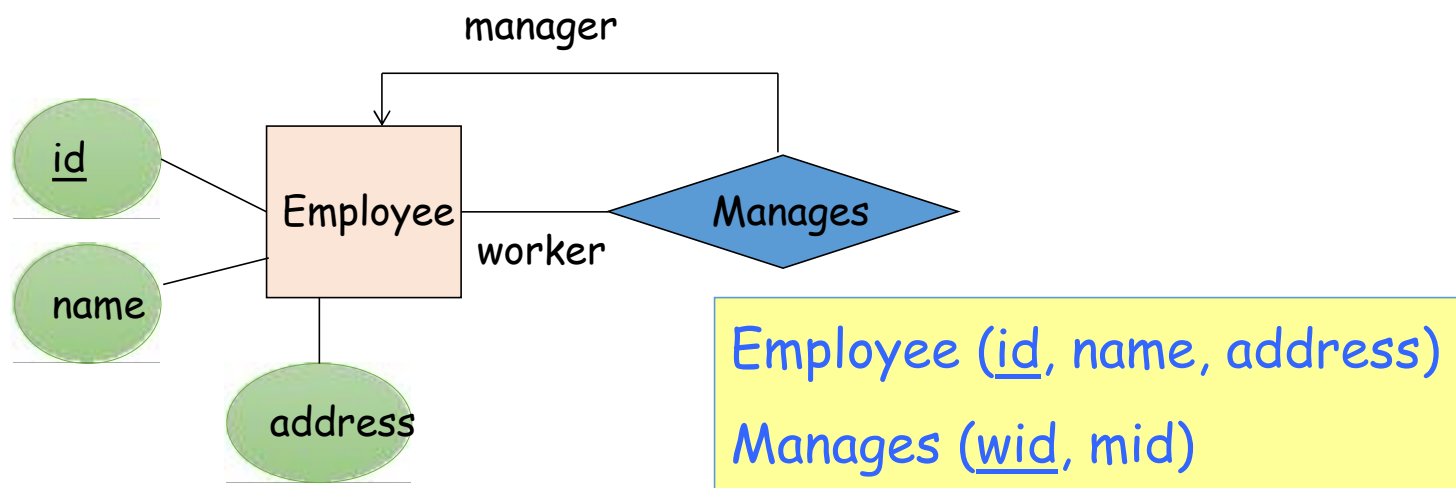
## Converting (1:1) Relationships to Relational Schema



```
CREATE TABLE Studio(  
  name CHAR(40),  
  address CHAR(40),  
  PRIMARY KEY (name)  
)
```

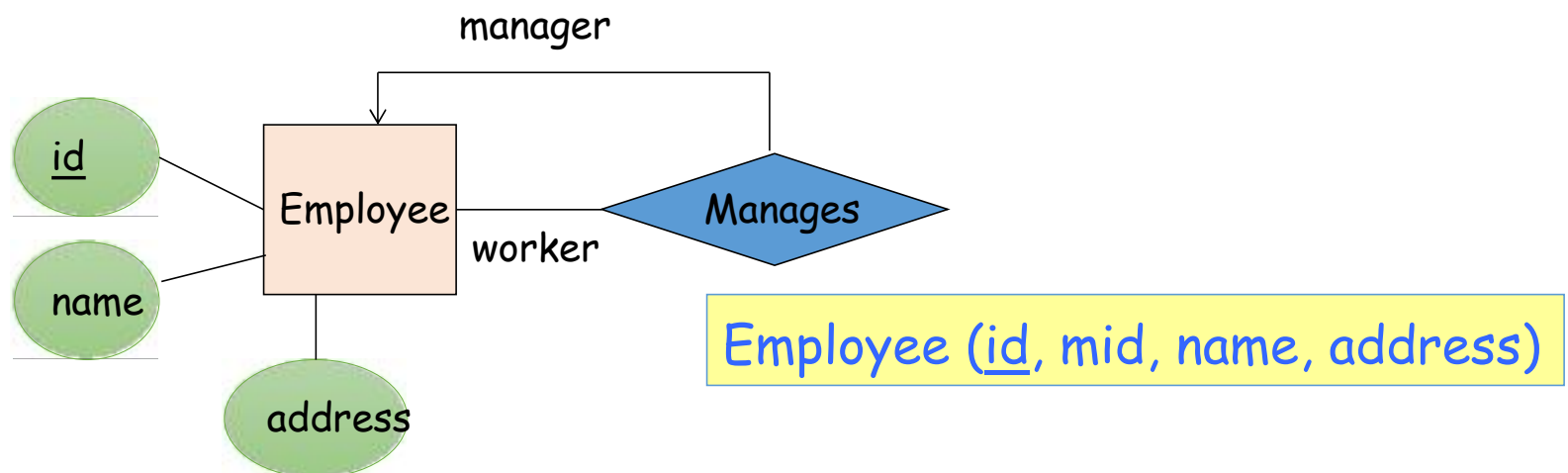
```
CREATE TABLE President(  
  name CHAR(40),  
  sname CHAR(40),  
  address VARCHAR(50),  
  PRIMARY KEY (name),  
  FOREIGN KEY (sname)  
    REFERENCES Studio(name)  
)
```

# Translating Recursive Relationship Sets (First option)



What are all the relations created for this diagram?

# Translating Recursive Relationship Sets (second option)

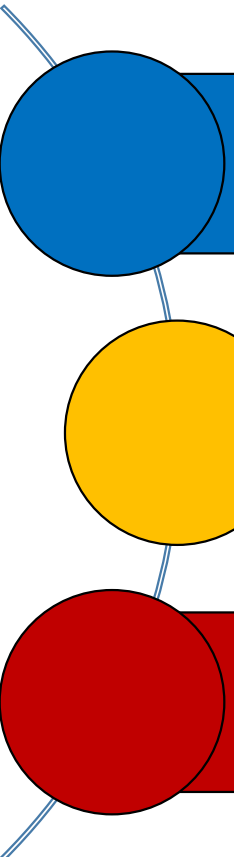


What are all the relations created for this diagram?

# 3. Advanced E/R Concepts



# What you will learn about in this section



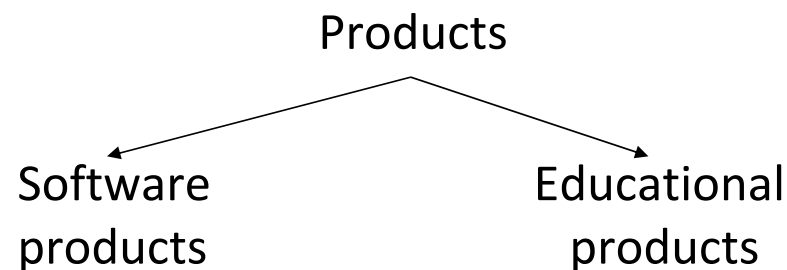
Subclasses & connection to OOP

Constraints

Weak entity sets

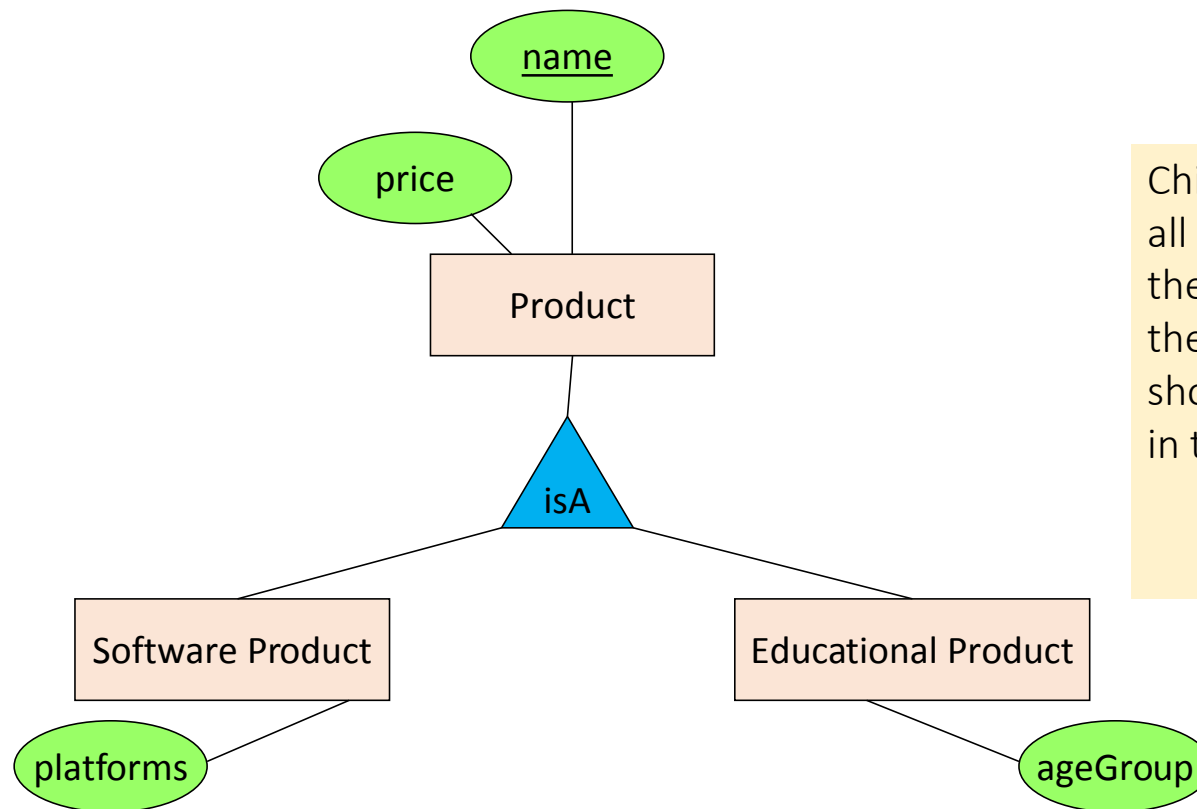
# Modeling Subclasses

- Some objects in a class may be special, i.e. worthy of their own class
  - Define a new class?
    - *But what if we want to maintain connection to current class?*
  - Better: define a *subclass*
    - *Ex:*



We can define subclasses in E/R!

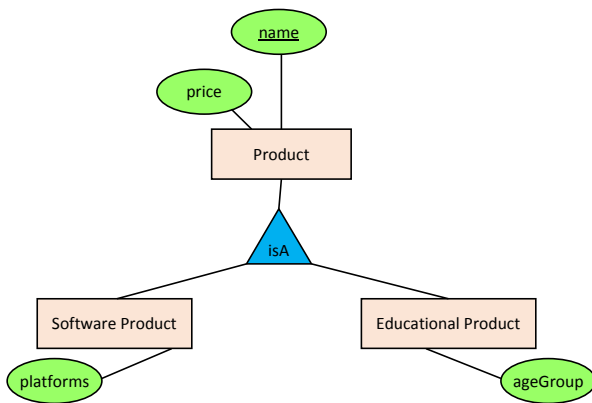
# Modeling Subclasses



Child subclasses contain all the attributes of *all* of their parent classes plus the new attributes shown attached to them in the E/R diagram

# Understanding Subclasses

- Think in terms of records; ex:



- Product

|       |
|-------|
| name  |
| price |

- SoftwareProduct

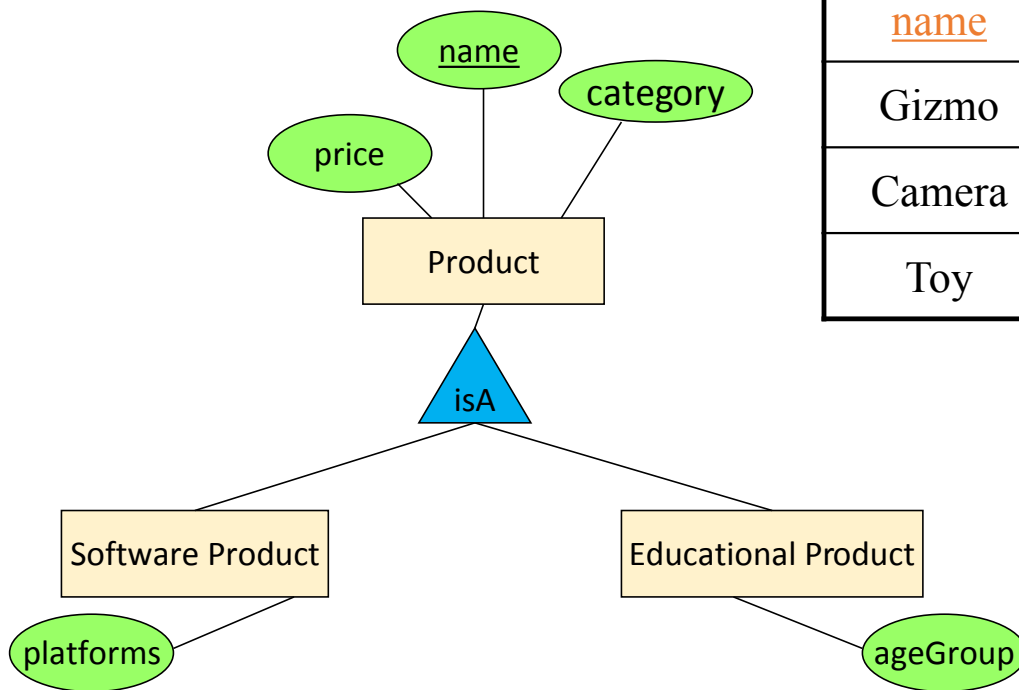
|           |
|-----------|
| name      |
| price     |
| platforms |

- EducationalProduct

|          |
|----------|
| name     |
| price    |
| ageGroup |

Child subclasses contain all the attributes of *all* of their parent classes plus the new attributes shown attached to them in the E/R diagram

# How to convert E/R to tables...

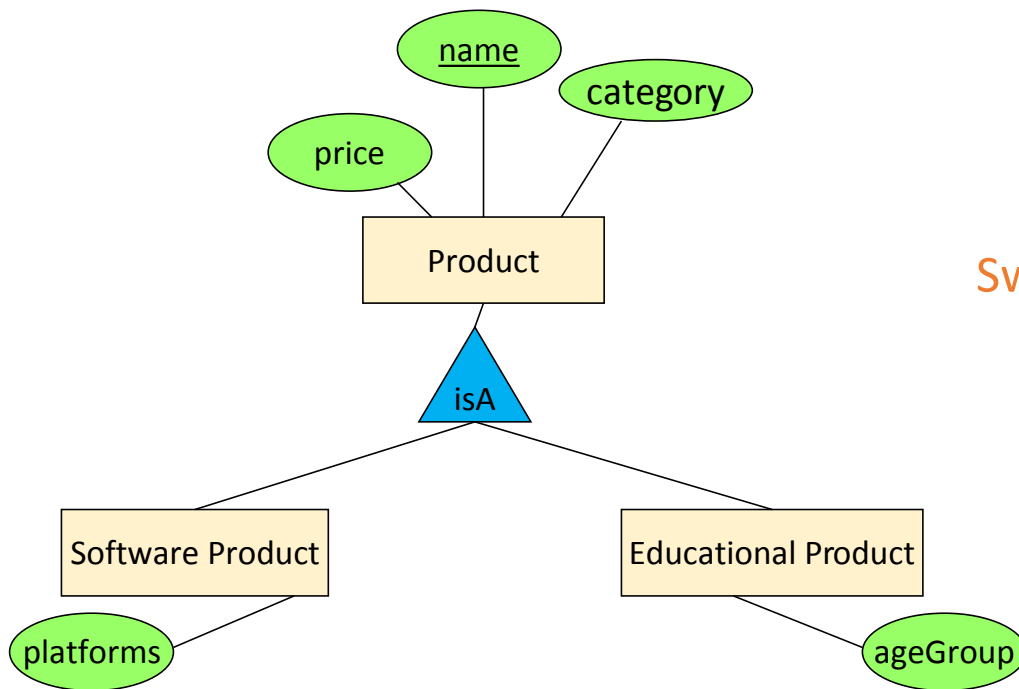


Product

| <u>name</u> | price | category | platforms | ageGroup |
|-------------|-------|----------|-----------|----------|
| Gizmo       | 99    | gadget   | unix      | null     |
| Camera      | 49    | photo    | null      | null     |
| Toy         | 39    | gadget   | null      | retired  |

Many null values!!

Better option: one table for each subclass...



### Product

| <u>name</u> | price | category |
|-------------|-------|----------|
| Gizmo       | 99    | gadget   |
| Camera      | 49    | photo    |
| Toy         | 39    | gadget   |

### Sw.Product

| <u>name</u> | platforms |
|-------------|-----------|
| Gizmo       | unix      |

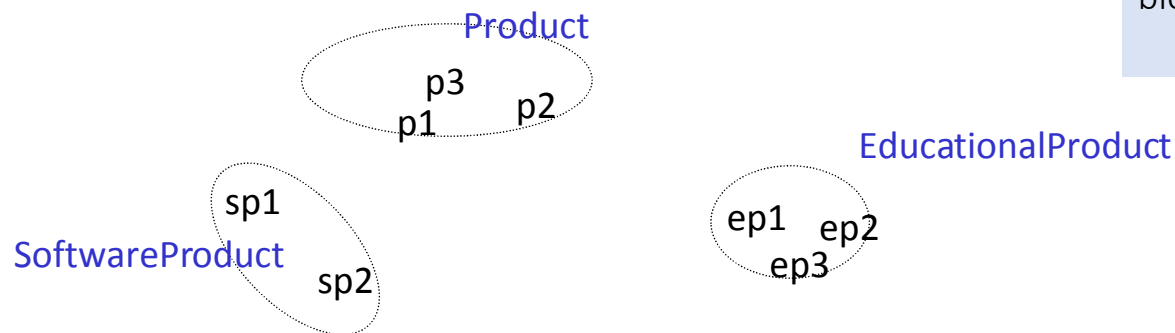
### Ed.Product

| <u>name</u> | ageGroup |
|-------------|----------|
| Toy         | retired  |

# Difference between OOP and E/R inheritance

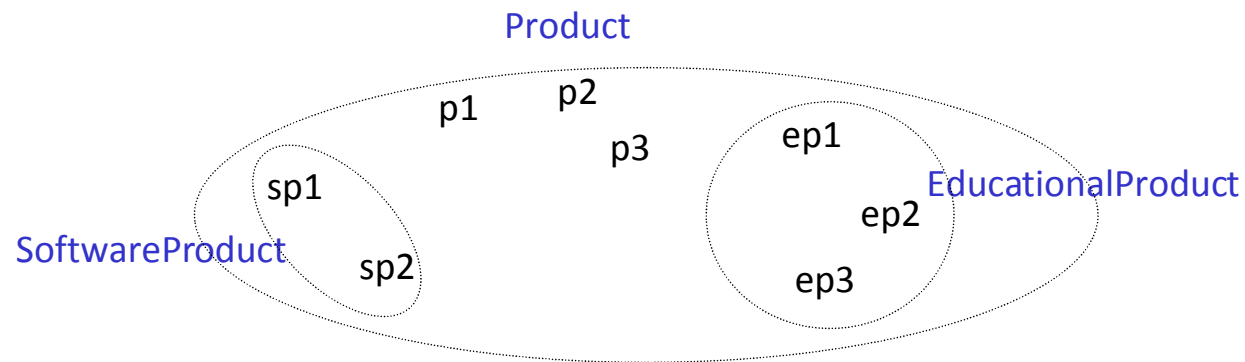
- OOP: Classes are disjoint (same for Java, C++)

OO = Object Oriented.  
E.g. classes as  
fundamental building  
block, etc...



# Difference between OOP and E/R inheritance

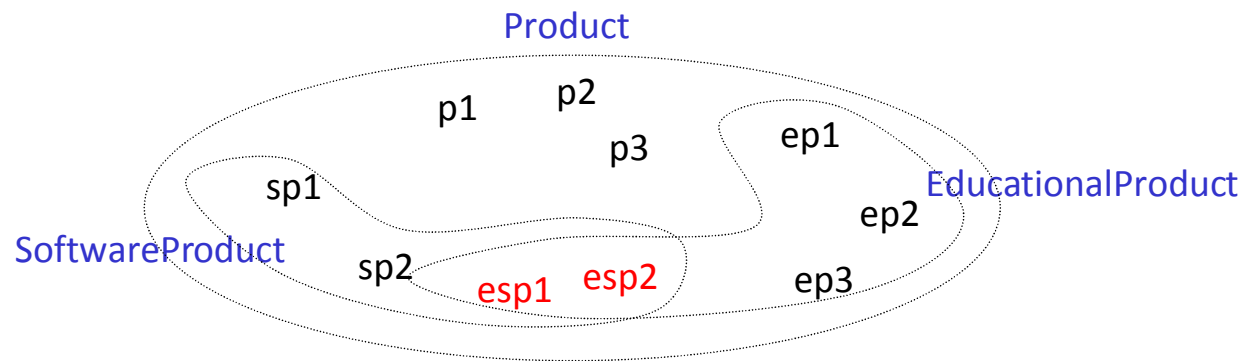
- E/R: entity sets overlap





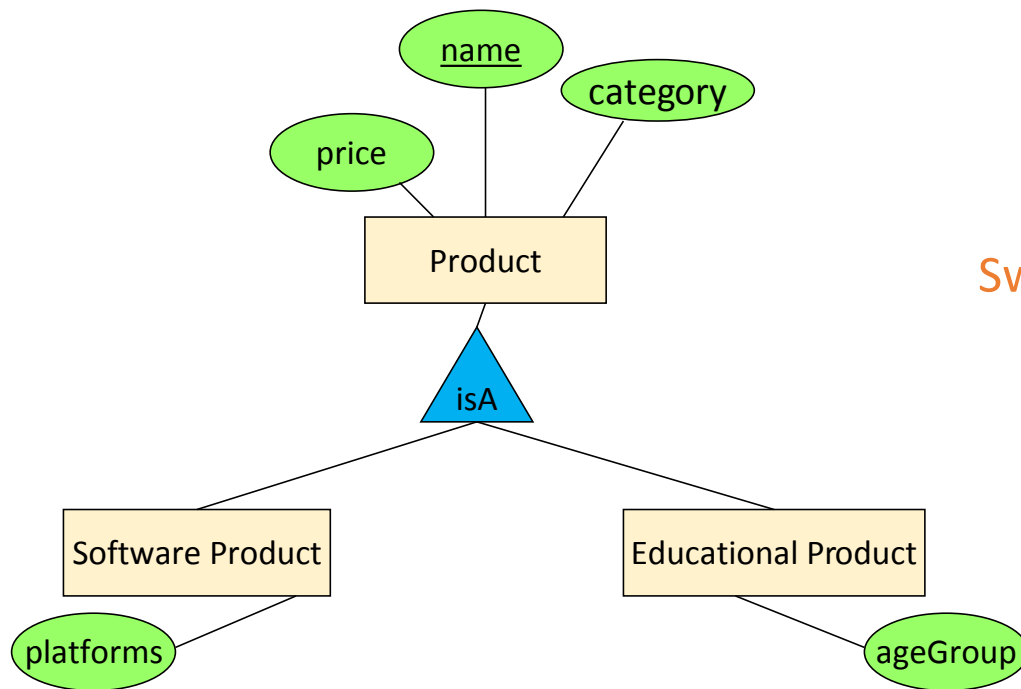
# Difference between OO and E/R inheritance

We have three entity sets, but four different kinds of objects



No need for multiple inheritance in E/R

Suppose we have a product KIDPIX which is an educational software... Where do we keep the information?



## Product

| <u>name</u> | price | category |
|-------------|-------|----------|
| Gizmo       | 99    | gadget   |
| Camera      | 49    | photo    |
| Toy         | 39    | gadget   |

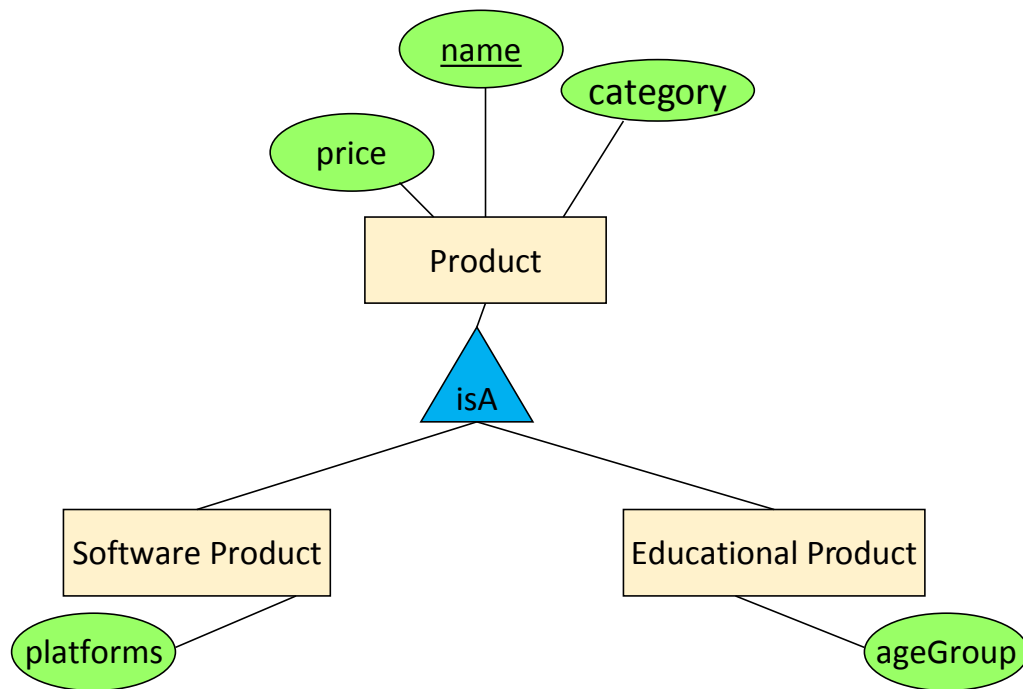
## Sw.Product

| <u>name</u> | platforms |
|-------------|-----------|
| Gizmo       | unix      |

## Ed.Product

| <u>name</u> | ageGroup |
|-------------|----------|
| Gizmo       | todler   |
| Toy         | retired  |

Suppose we have a product KIDPIX which is an educational software... Where do we keep the information?



## Product

| <u>name</u>   | price      | category      |
|---------------|------------|---------------|
| Gizmo         | 99         | gadget        |
| Camera        | 49         | photo         |
| Toy           | 39         | gadget        |
| <b>KidPix</b> | <b>100</b> | <b>gadget</b> |

| <u>name</u>   | platforms        |
|---------------|------------------|
| Gizmo         | unix             |
| <b>KidPix</b> | <b>Macintosh</b> |

## Sw.Product

| <u>name</u>   | ageGroup      |
|---------------|---------------|
| Toy           | retired       |
| <b>KidPix</b> | <b>todler</b> |

## Ed.Product

# IsA Review

- If we declare ***A IsA B*** then every **A** is a **B**
- We use IsA to
  - Add descriptive attributes to a subclass
  - To identify entities that participate in a relationship
  - No table for IsA relationship
- **No need for multiple inheritance**

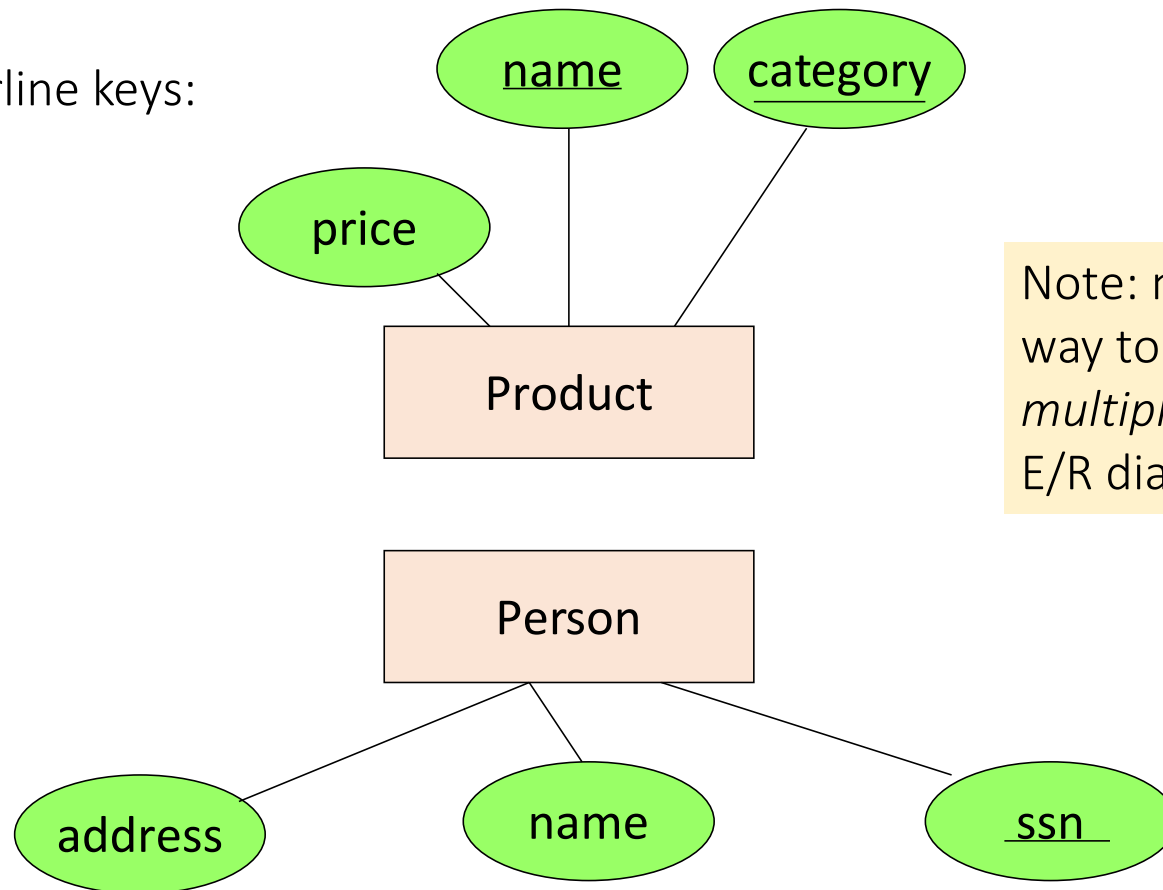
# Constraints in E/R Diagrams

- Finding constraints is part of the E/R modeling process. Commonly used constraints are:
  - Keys: Implicit constraints on uniqueness of entities
    - *Ex: An SSN uniquely identifies a person*
  - Single-value constraints:
    - *Ex: a product can be made by only one company*
  - Referential integrity constraints: Referenced entities must exist
    - *Ex: if you work for a company, it must exist in the database*
  - Degree constraints:
    - *Ex: A movie may not have more than 10 actors*

Recall  
FOREIGN  
KEYs!

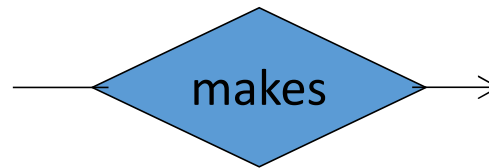
# Keys in E/R Diagrams

Underline keys:

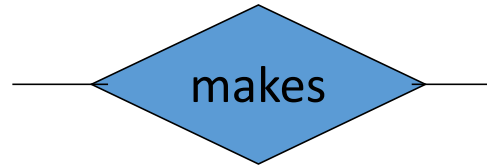


Note: no formal way to specify *multiple* keys in E/R diagrams...

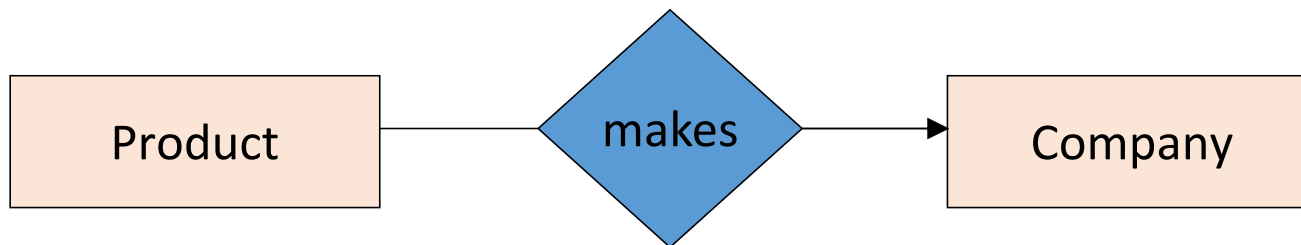
# Single Value Constraints



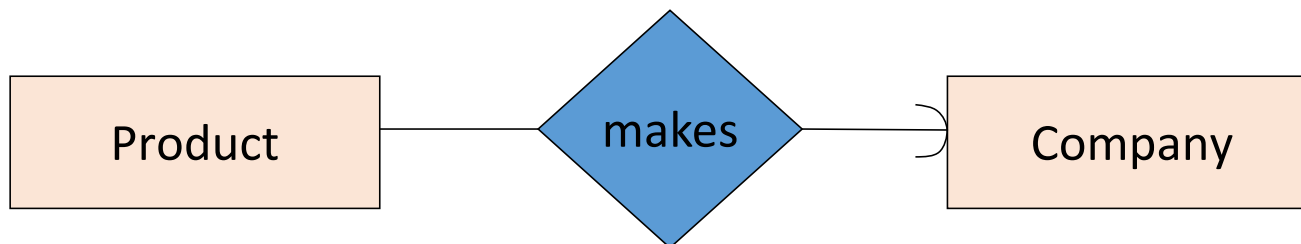
v. s.



# Referential Integrity Constraints



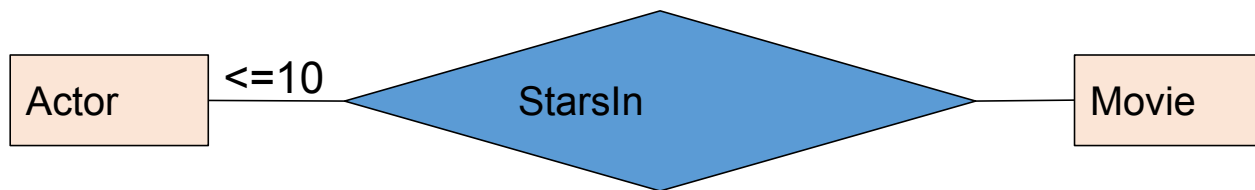
Each product made by at most one company.  
Some products made by no company?



Each product is made by exactly one company.



# Degree Constraints



- We can attach a bounding number to edges to indicate limits on the number of entities that can be connected to a single entity via a relationship set
- In the example above, a movie has at most 10 stars
- Note: a regular arrow is the constraint  $\leq 1$
- Note: a rounded arrow is the constraint  $= 1$

# Weak Entity Sets

The entity set that can not exist without another entity set

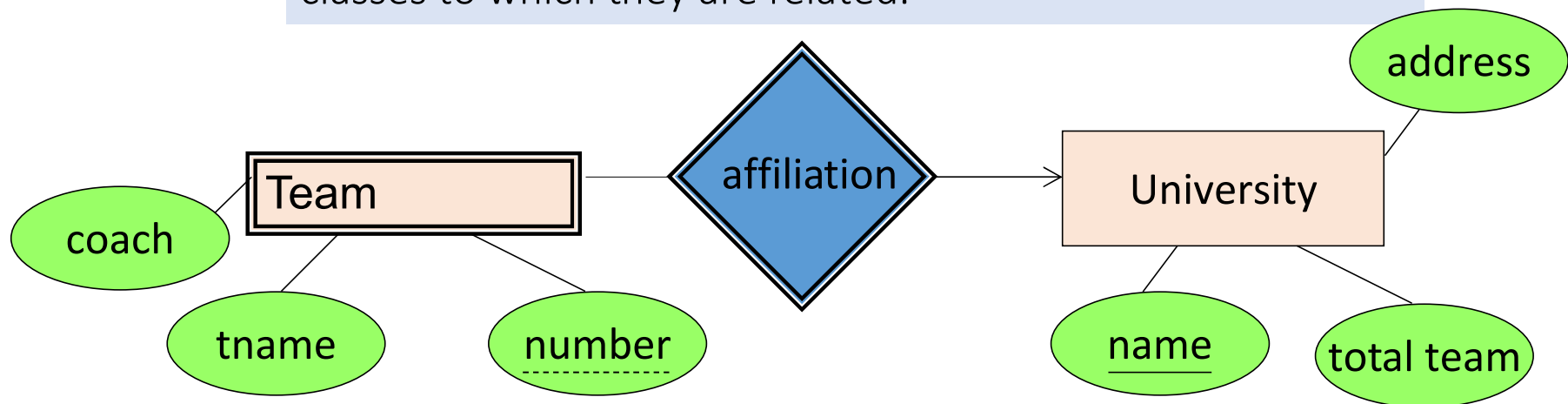
a ROOM can only exist in a BUILDING

a TIRE is considered as a strong entity because it can exist without being attached to a CAR

Question is strong entity type and answer is weak. Question is always there, but an answer requires a question to exist.

# Weak Entity Sets

Entity sets are weak when their key comes from other classes to which they are related.



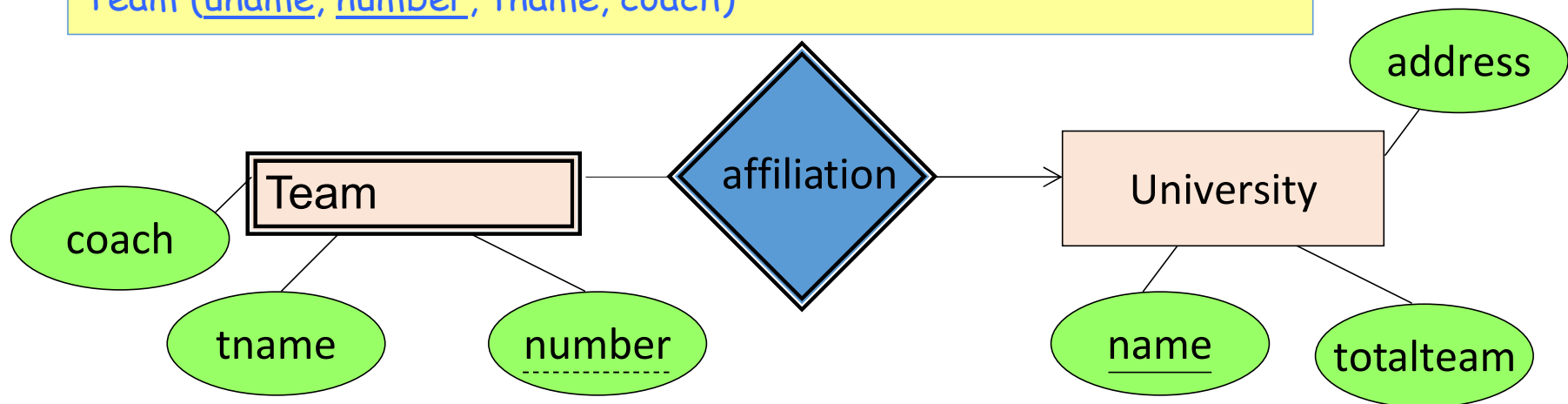
“Programming contest team” v. “*BUET Programming contest team*” (E.g., Dhaka university has a programming contest team too)

# Weak Entity Sets

Only 2 tables are required, no table for the relationship is required

University (name, totalTeam, address)

Team (uname, number, tname, coach)



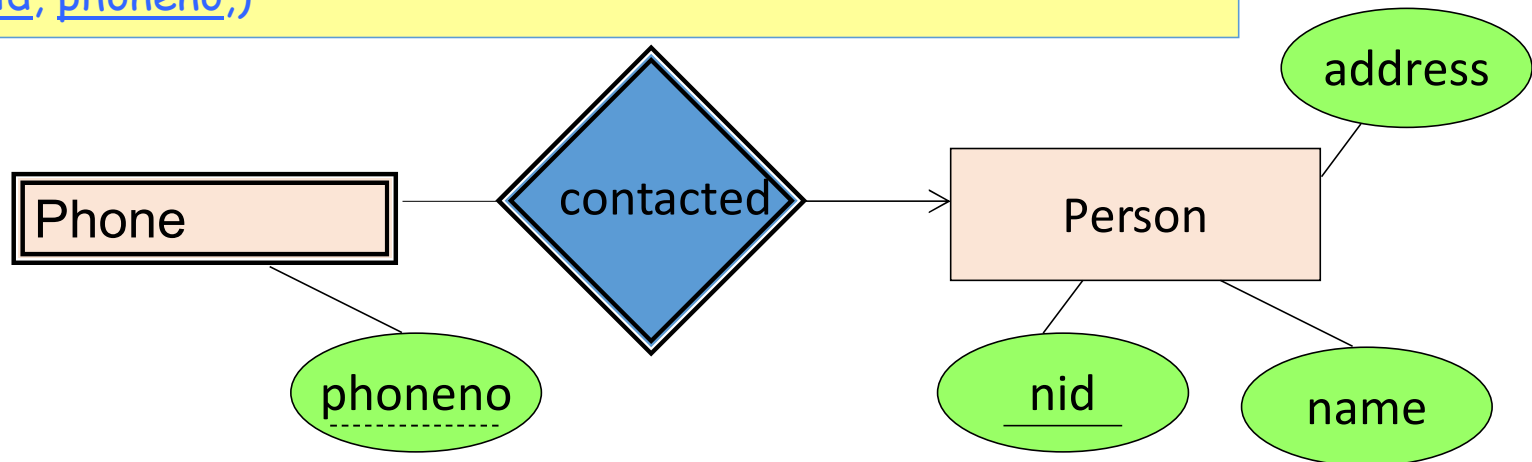
- number is a partial key. (denote with dashed underline).
- University is called the identifying owner.

# Weak Entity Sets

Only 2 tables are required, no table for the relationship is required

Person (nid, name, address)

Phone (nid, phoneno,)



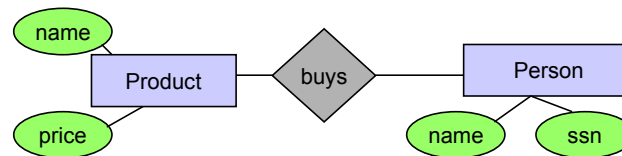
- Phone no is a *partial key*. (denote with dashed underline).
- Person is called the *identifying owner*.

# E/R Summary

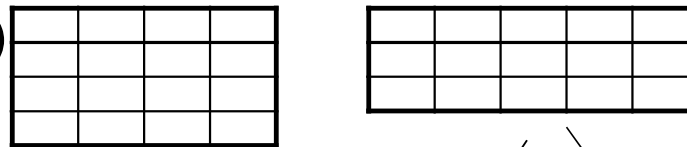
- E/R diagrams are a visual syntax that allows technical and non-technical people to talk
  - For conceptual design
- Basic constructs: **entity**, **relationship**, and **attributes**
- A good design is faithful to the constraints of the application

# The bigger picture of what we have learned

Conceptual Model:



Relational Model (in 1NF)  
plus FD's



Normalization:  
Eliminates **anomalies**

